



CITY: Pg 3

High-tech labs coming to 4 ITIs soon, says CM



NATION: Pg 5

Stalin torches copy of delimitation Bill



FILM: Pg 14

'Grateful for the opportunities'

THE GREAT DELIMITATION DEBATE ROCKS LOK SABHA | VOTING ON 3 BILLS TO BE HELD TODAY

Govt assures fair delimitation, Oppn unconvinced

PM Modi asserts in LS: No state, be it north or south will be discriminated against in delimitation exercise

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Strongly pitching for women's quota and delimitation Bills, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday asserted that no state -- big or small, north or south, east or west -- will be discriminated against in the delimitation of constituencies linked with the implementation of the women's quota law.

While strongly backing implementation of the reservation in 2029, he warned that those who oppose this initiative will not be forgiven by the women of the country.

PM Modi spoke on the first day of the special session of the Parliament, pushing for all parties to "collectively" ensure the passage of the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam or The Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-eighth Amendment) Bill, 2023.

Intervening in the debate in Lok Sabha on the three Bills introduced for amendment of the women's quota law and to set up a delimitation commission, Modi also said if any political party opposes the women quota law, it is quite natural that he (Modi) would be politically benefited.

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Prime Minister Narendra Modi speaks in the Lok Sabha during the Special session of Parliament, in New Delhi PTI

LOK SABHA NUMBER GAME

Total strength of the House is **540**
Two thirds majority required is **360**
NDA has **293** members and falls short by **67**
Opposition has **233** members
Others account for **14** members

RAJYA SABHA NUMBER GAME

Two thirds majority required is **163**
NDA has **141** members and falls short by **22**
Opposition has **83** members
Others account for **20** members and remain decisive

IMPACT OF ABSTENTIONS

If **30** members abstain
Effective strength becomes **510**
Two thirds mark becomes **340**
NDA still falls short by **47**
If **60** members abstain
Effective strength becomes **480**
Two thirds mark becomes **320**

» The ruling alliance does not have the required numbers in either House

» Passage of the Bill depends on opposition support or strategic abstentions

NDA still falls short by **27**
If **90** members abstain
Effective strength becomes **450**
Two thirds mark becomes **300**
NDA still falls short by **7**
Even with large abstentions, additional support is required

» Regional parties and smaller blocs could play a decisive role

KEY OPPOSITION STRENGTH

- » Congress has 98 members
- » Samajwadi Party has 37 members
- » Trinamool Congress has 28 members
- » DMK has 22 members
- » Support or abstention from at least two major opposition parties is crucial

South to gain seats proportionally, representation share intact: Shah

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Thursday asserted that the Lok Sabha seats in five southern states will go up to 195 from the present 129, an increase of 50 per cent, when the total seats in the Lower House will be enhanced to 816, saying a false narrative is being spread to float misleading information.

Intervening in the debate in Lok Sabha on the three bills introduced for amendment of the wom-

LOK SABHA SEATS IN SOUTH TO RISE FROM 129 TO 195

Karnataka 28→42
Andhra Pradesh 25→38
Telangana 17→26
Tamil Nadu 39→59
Kerala 20→30

en's quota law and to set up a delimitation commission, Shah also said the proposed women's reservation will be implemented only in 2029 and till then all polls will be conducted under the present system.

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Trump says Israel, Lebanon agreed to 10-day ceasefire

Pak Army chief Munir holds talks with top Iranian leadership in Tehran



A woman walks past a billboard that shows a graphic depicting a military personnel's hand holding the Strait of Hormuz in his fist with signs which read in Farsi: 'In Iran's hands forever' 'Trump couldn't do a damn thing,' 'The control of Strait of Hormuz will be Iran's forever,' in northern Tehran AP/PTI

ASSOCIATED PRESS

CAIRO: A 10-day ceasefire between Israel and Lebanon is set to take effect at 5 pm Eastern on Thursday, United States President Donald Trump announced, marking a tentative pause after more than a month of fighting between Israel and the Iran-backed Hezbollah group. The development comes alongside renewed diplomatic activity in West Asia, including parallel efforts involving Pakistan and Iran aimed at easing tensions linked to the wider US-Iran conflict.

Trump said the agreement followed direct conversations with Lebanese President Joseph Aoun and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, describing the exchanges as "excellent". In a post on Truth Social, he said both leaders had agreed to the temporary halt in hostilities as a step toward peace. "These two leaders have agreed that in order to achieve peace between their countries, they will formally begin a 10 day ceasefire at 5 P.M. EST," he said.

The ceasefire follows rare direct talks between Israeli and Lebanese officials in

CLOSER LOOK

- » Breakthrough comes after first direct Israel-Lebanon talks in 34 years
- » Trump holds calls with Lebanese President Joseph Aoun and Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu before announcement
- » Netanyahu and Aoun invited to White House for first high-level talks since 1983
- » Lebanon insists ceasefire must precede further negotiations, reiterates commitment to disarm Hezbollah

Washington earlier this week, their first such engagement in 34 years. The meeting was held on Tuesday in the presence of US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, signalling a renewed American push to bring both sides to the negotiating table after decades of limited formal contact.

Trump also extended invitations to Netanyahu and Aoun for what he described as the first meaningful high-level talks between Israel and Lebanon since 1983. He said he had directed Vice President JD Vance,

Continued on P4

Opposition alleges govt using women's quota to push delimitation

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Opposition parties mounted a coordinated attack in the Lok Sabha on Thursday during a heated debate on the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, with several leaders questioning both the timing of the legislation and its link to the proposed delimitation exercise. While reiterating support for women's reservation, they

accused the Centre of attempting to redraw the electoral map under its cover.

Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra emerged as one of the most forceful voices in the debate, directly countering Prime Minister Narendra Modi's claims on women's empowerment. She argued that the Bill "has nothing to do with women" and instead raises deeper concerns about representation and fairness. Taking



aim at the government's narrative, she said the Prime Minister's speech projected the BJP as the sole champion of women's reservation while "claiming he

“HAD THE PRIME MINISTER UNDERTAKEN THIS HISTORIC STEP WITH SINCERITY, THE ENTIRE HOUSE WOULD HAVE SUPPORTED IT”

did not want credit".

Drawing on history, Vadra referred to the 1928 Motilal Nehru report, which had already articulated equal rights

for women, to challenge the claim that the idea had been delayed for decades. She stressed that the Congress had supported the 2023 women's reservation law in line with its ideology. In a sharp remark, she said, "Baar baar behkaane wale purushon ko mahilaayein jhat se pehchan leti hain," asserting that women can see through repeated attempts to mislead them.

Backing her stance, Con-

gress MP Gaurav Gogoi, who opened the Opposition's arguments, termed the legislation a "backdoor Bill for delimitation," alleging that the government had merely placed a women's reservation label on a broader political exercise. K C Venugopal echoed this, saying the Opposition was ready to support immediate implementation under the existing strength of Parliament and accusing the

Continued on P4

Macron dials Modi; calls for restoring freedom of navigation in Hormuz

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday held a telephone conversation with French President Emmanuel Macron to discuss the ongoing crisis in West Asia, with both leaders calling for the immediate restoration of safe navigation through the Strait of Hormuz.

The call was initiated by Macron and comes as the conflict in the region approaches 50 days. In a post on X following the exchange, Modi said, "Received a phone call from my dear friend President Emmanuel Macron. We discussed the situation in West Asia and agreed on the need to urgently restore safety and freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz. We will continue our close coopera-

The leaders had previously spoken on March 5, when they shared concerns over the deteriorating situation and called for a return to dialogue and diplomacy

tion to advance peace and stability in the region and beyond."

The leaders had previously spoken on March 5, when they shared concerns over the deteriorating situation and called for a return to dialogue and diplomacy.

India has maintained that de-escalation remains key to resolving the crisis. At an inter-ministerial briefing on Wednesday, Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson

Randhir Jaiswal said diplomatic engagement by India is ongoing. He also referred to a recent conversation between Modi and US President Donald Trump, during which the West Asia situation was discussed.

The conflict began on February 28 after US and Israeli strikes on Iran, followed by retaliatory attacks by Tehran targeting Gulf nations hosting American military bases. Amid disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar said attacks on merchant vessels were "completely unacceptable" as India pushed for unimpeded maritime transit.

The strategic waterway, which carries about 20 per cent of global oil and LNG trade, has seen restrictions imposed by Iran, triggering a surge in global energy prices.

SAFE IN HER ARMS



Tourists visit Taj Mahal on a hot summer day, in Agra, Uttar Pradesh

PTI

GRAP-1 curbs imposed in Delhi-NCR as air quality slips into 'poor'

NEW DELHI: The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) on Thursday imposed stage one measures in Delhi-NCR under the Graded Response Action Plan as air quality slipped into 'poor' category, officials said. "The AQI of Delhi has been showing an increasing trend owing to unfavourable meteorological conditions and recorded as 226 ('Poor' Category) today. Further, the forecast by IMD and IITM has also predicted AQI to remain in the 'Poor' category in the next two days," a senior official said. "The sub-committee of CAQM, accordingly, decided to invoke all actions under stage-1 ('Poor' air quality) of the extant GRAP in the entire NCR, with immediate effect," the official added.

Stage 1 measures entail periodic mechanised sweeping and water sprinkling on roads, dust mitigation at construction sites, proper waste management, strict checks on polluting vehicles, better traffic management, and emission controls in industries, power plants, and brick kilns.

MPOST

INDIA WAS A MAJOR BENEFICIARY, ORDERING AROUND 30 MN BARRELS

US declines to extend sanctions waiver that let India import Russian crude oil

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The United States has announced it will not extend sanctions waivers that had temporarily allowed countries, including India, to continue purchasing Russian and Iranian oil, marking a shift in Washington's approach as global energy markets remain volatile amid ongoing geopolitical tensions.

Speaking at the White House on Wednesday, US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent confirmed that the exemptions had run their course. "We will not be renewing the general licence on Russian



oil, and we will not be renewing the general licence on Iranian oil. That was oil that was on the water prior to March 11, so all that has been used," he said. The decision effectively ends a short-

term policy introduced to ease supply disruptions and contain rising energy prices during escalating conflict in West Asia.

The waivers were initially designed to allow oil already

loaded onto tankers before specific deadlines to reach buyers. After tensions around the Strait of Hormuz disrupted shipping routes in March, Washington issued a 30-day

Continued on P4

KEY POINTS

- » India imported Russian fossil fuels worth about \$6.3 billion in March 2026
- » Crude oil made up roughly \$5.7 billion, or 91 per cent, of total imports
- » Imports surged sharply from about \$1.9 billion in February

SC fixes deadline to add tribunal-cleared voters in Bengal electoral roll

SOUMYADIP MULLICK

KOLKATA: Exercising its special powers under Article 142, the Supreme Court has allowed the preparation of a supplementary electoral roll ahead of the West Bengal Assembly elections, ensuring that voters cleared by Appellate Tribunals can participate in polling if decisions come within a fixed timeline.

Millennium Post had reported on April 13 that SC is "seeking to focus" on the publication of a supplementary electoral roll based on the progress of appeals disposed of within a week.

Hearing a batch of petitions on the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, the Bench

Directs EC to include names in supplementary list

of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi directed the Election Commission to implement tribunal decisions through a supplementary revised list before voting dates.

The court said that where appeals are decided by April 21 for the first phase and April 27 for the second phase, the outcomes must be reflected in the electoral roll and all consequential rights, including the right to vote, must follow.

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MATCH MADE IN FRAUD

Love, lies, ₹2 cr: 500 hearts, 1 con

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Doctor, lawyer, film producer, model, businessman — behind many online personas is a 35-year-old man who allegedly duped over 500 women across the country of more than Rs 2 crore by using fake social media or dating app profiles, emotional stories and promises of marriage to lure victims into his trap.

The accused, Anand Kumar, was arrested by a team of southwest cyber police for allegedly running an organised network of romance scams, honey-trapping and online blackmail targeting women through dating and matrimonial platforms. Deputy Commissioner of Police (Southwest) Amit Goel in a statement said.

Kumar used multiple fake identities on various social media platforms as well as on dating and matrimonial applications, to approach unsuspecting women.

“He would present himself as a well-settled professional with an impressive background, often claiming to be a doctor, businessman or film producer to gain credibility and attract

LOVE SCAM

» The accused, Anand Kumar, was arrested by a team of southwest cyber police for allegedly running an organised network of romance scams, honey-trapping and online blackmail targeting women through dating and matrimonial platforms: Police

» Kumar used multiple fake identities on various

social media platforms as well as on dating and matrimonial applications, to approach unsuspecting women

» He would present himself as a well-settled professional with an impressive background, often claiming to be a doctor, businessman or film producer to gain credibility and attract victims: Police

victims,” the DCP said.

According to investigators, the accused would initiate friendly conversations and gradually build emotional connections with the victims over days or weeks. After establishing trust, he would shift communication to private messaging platforms, using multiple mobile numbers to avoid detection.

“The accused carefully crafted his ‘personas’ and maintained parallel conversations with several victims at the same time. He exploited emotional vulnerabilities and created a

sense of intimacy to manipulate victims into trusting him,” he added.

The officer said once he gained the victims confidence, Kumar would introduce fabricated narratives, including urgent medical emergencies, business losses, family crises or financial setbacks, to solicit money. In several instances, he also promised marriage or lucrative opportunities such as modelling assignments or admissions to reputed institutions as a means to lure victims.

“In one case, a woman was

allegedly cheated of around Rs 7 lakh after being contacted by a fake profile operating under the name-Vaibhav Arora. The accused initially befriended her on a dating app and later developed a romantic relationship, promising marriage. He further strengthened his deception by introducing another fictitious identity, claiming it to be his friend who would help formalise their relationship,” the officer said.

Police said Kumar subsequently fabricated stories of financial distress and sought monetary assistance from the victim. When she began demanding her money back, he stopped responding and later falsely claimed that the person she knew had died, in an attempt to cut off communication and evade suspicion.

An FIR into the matter was registered and further investigation was launched. A team scanned the money trail, bank accounts and technical analysis to trace the accused.

The accused was apprehended from West Bengal on March 22.

Investigation also suggested that apart from financial

fraud, the accused also allegedly engaged in extortion by exploiting private content shared by victims.

During online interactions, he would persuade women to share personal photos or videos, which he later used to threaten them with exposure on social media platforms if they refused to pay money, police said.

They said Kumar operated with a “high level of sophistication”, using multiple mobile phones and SIM cards obtained under different identities. He frequently switched devices and accounts to avoid being traced, making it difficult for law enforcement agencies to track his activities.

During interrogation and examination of his devices, police found that he was simultaneously operating numerous fake identities and communicating with victims across multiple states. “Technical analysis revealed that the accused had targeted more than 500 women and cheated or extorted approximately Rs 2 crore,” the officer said, adding that he had previous involvement in similar cases in Delhi and Ghaziabad. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Akasa, SpiceJet planes brush at Delhi Airport

NEW DELHI: An Akasa Air aircraft and a SpiceJet plane suffered damage after they came in contact at the Delhi airport on Thursday afternoon, and aviation watchdog DGCA is probing the incident, according to officials.

Both Boeing 737 aircraft have been grounded at the airport after the incident.

The officials said the Akasa Air aircraft was stationary on the taxiway and preparing for take off, while the SpiceJet plane was taxiing towards the parking stand when the incident happened at around 2.15 pm at Terminal 1 of the airport.

Akasa Air's plane was to operate flight QP 1406 from Delhi to Hyderabad, while the SpiceJet aircraft had arrived from Leh after operating the flight SG 124, they added.

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) said the winglet of SpiceJet's Boeing 737-700 aircraft, VT-SLB, taxiing in the allocated parking bay after operating flight SG 124 (Leh-Delhi) hit Horizontal Tail Surface (HTS) of Akasa



Damage reported; DGCA starts probe

Boeing 737 plane positioned on the apron after push back for operating flight on sector (Delhi-Hyderabad).

“Due to impact, RH winglet of Spicejet aircraft and HTS of Akasa Air aircraft were damaged. DGCA is carrying out further investigation,” it said in a statement. Akasa Air said its aircraft operating the flight QP 1406 from Delhi to Hyderabad had to return to the bay.

Preliminary information indicates that Akasa Air's aircraft was stationary when another airline's aircraft made contact with it, the airline said in a statement. The aircraft involved was a Boeing 737 MAX 8. The airline

said all passengers and crew were safely disembarked. “In line with established protocols, the relevant authorities have been informed, and the matter is under investigation,” it added. In a statement, SpiceJet said its Boeing 737-700 aircraft was involved in a ground occurrence while taxiing at the Delhi airport, resulting in damage to its right winglet and the left-hand horizontal stabiliser of another aircraft belonging to a different airline. The SpiceJet aircraft has been grounded at Delhi, it added. Citing preliminary information, the officials said the wings of both aircraft came in contact on the taxiway. PTI

Capital SIZZLES at season's first 40°C

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi on Thursday felt the first smite of approaching summer as the mercury breached the 40 degrees Celsius mark, the highest this year so far.

Safdarjung recorded a maximum temperature of 40.3 degrees Celsius, 3.5 degrees above normal, while the minimum settled at 20.3 degrees Celsius, 1.3 degrees below normal. Palam saw a maximum of 39.4 degrees Celsius, 2.0 degrees above normal, and a minimum of 21.6 degrees Celsius, marginally 0.2 degrees below normal.

At Lodhi Road, the maximum temperature was 40.1 degrees Celsius, 4.1 degrees above normal, while the minimum stood at 18.8 degrees Celsius, 2.2 degrees below normal.

The Ridge station recorded the highest maximum at 41.4 degrees Celsius, 3.4 degrees above normal, with the mini-

mum at 22.5 degrees Celsius, 0.5 degrees below normal.

Ayanagar reported a maximum of 40.5 degrees Celsius, 2.8 degrees above normal, while the minimum dropped to 18.2 degrees Celsius, 3.9 degrees below normal.

The India Meteorological Department has forecast a maximum temperature of around 41 degrees Celsius and a minimum of around 23 degrees Celsius on Friday, with a partly cloudy sky and the possibility of development of thunder and lightning.

Meanwhile, Delhi's Air Quality Index plummeted to 226, into the ‘poor’ category, prompting authorities to invoke Stage 1 of the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP) in the national capital.

As per CPCB standards, an AQI of 0–50 is considered ‘good’, 51–100 ‘satisfactory’, 101–200 ‘moderate’, 201–300 ‘poor’, 301–400 ‘very poor’, and 401–500 ‘severe’.



NBCC commemorated the birth anniversary of Bharat Ratna Dr. B.R. Ambedkar with great reverence at Leisure Valley, Greater Noida MPOST

City Briefs

DMRC WORKER DIES IN ACCIDENT DURING CLEANING WORK IN SOUTH DELHI

NEW DELHI: A worker engaged in cleaning work assigned by the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) died after a backhoe loader he was operating lost control and overturned at a site in south Delhi, an official said on Thursday. According to a statement issued by the DMRC, the incident occurred when the operator, employed with contractor K R Anand, was hauling debris at Sunheri Nallah.

FIRE BREAKS OUT IN GHAZIABAD VILLAGE, OVER 150 SHANTIES GUTTED

GHAZIABAD: Over 150 shanties were gutted when a massive fire broke out in a village here on Thursday afternoon, officials said. No loss of life has been reported so far, they said.

VISUALLY IMPAIRED WOMAN CHEATED OF Rs 14.5 LAKH IN PROPERTY FRAUD

NEW DELHI: A 51-year-old man was arrested for allegedly cheating a visually impaired woman of Rs 14.5 lakh on the pretext of leasing a residential property in central Delhi, officials said on Thursday. The arrest unearthed a wider fraud of nearly Rs 2 crore involving multiple victims, they said. The accused, as Ravindra Garg, a resident of Hapur in Uttar Pradesh, was apprehended by a team last week, they added.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is planning to conduct feasibility studies for the construction of underpasses at railway crossings as part of its broader traffic decongestion initiative, officials said on Thursday. At present, there are around 8–10 railway crossings across the national capital that experience heavy congestion. Residents are often forced to take longer alternate routes to avoid traffic jams, resulting in increased commuting time, they said.

COP RESCUES man from burning house

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi Police head constable rescued a 41-year-old man trapped in a house that caught fire here, an official said on Thursday.

The incident occurred in Outer North Delhi's Swaroop Nagar on April 12.

The police officer said after receiving a PCR call, a team rushed to the spot.

“Head Constable Ankit found a man trapped on the first floor of the building as flames engulfed the premises,”

“The vehicle load at these crossings is heavy. We are working on a plan to study whether we can construct a tunnel underneath the Punjabi Bagh and Peeragarhi Chowk to facilitate easier movement for people living on either side of the line,” the Public Works Department (PWD) minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said. At present, a five-kilometre-long railway line passes between Punjabi Bagh and Paschim Vihar on one side and Rani Bagh and Pitampura on the other. We are planning to construct a tunnel or an overbridge at the location, whichever

is found more feasible, he added. According to officials, the vehicle load at these crossings is heavy. Since these are manned railway crossings, an alternative route is being planned.

“The PWD will be carrying out a survey of the buildings, encroachments, trees, road signage, and other permanent structures around these crossings. The study would also take into account vehicles’ parking space on these stretches and the timing of the closing and opening of railway crossings,” a PWD official said.

Such a study is conducted



CM Rekha Gupta interacts with members of the Rajasthani community during an outreach event in Coimbatore, praising their contribution to nation-building and economic growth MPOST

SFI wins student council elections at Ambedkar University Delhi

NEW DELHI: The Students' Federation of India has won the student council elections 2026 at Dr B R Ambedkar University (AUD), describing the victory as a “decisive rejection of anti-student agenda pursued by the administration”.

At the Kashmiri Gate campus, SFI has secured the support of 13 councillors, thereby securing a majority in the 25-member council, emerging as the winner for the fourth consecutive time, the student organisation said in a statement on Thursday. “AUD student elections are conducted in two tiers. In tier one, the councillors are chosen, and then in tier two, the student organisation securing the support of the majority of councillors wins,” explained Sooraj Elamon, president of Delhi SFI unit, adding, “This is the fourth consecutive time that SFI has won the majority of councillor support.” Elamon added that in the Karampura campus, SFI has delivered an equally impressive performance, winning five out of the seven seats it contested. PTI

TOTAL CHARGING POINTS OVER 10,000
Capital's EV charging infra registers ‘record’ expansion

NEW DELHI: The EV charging infra in Delhi has witnessed “record” expansion in the last one year with the total number of charging points rising to over 10,000, of which more than 3,000 were added in the past few months, an official said on Wednesday.

Delhi Power minister Ashish Sood said that the fast rise in the number of charging points in the city is an outcome of the policy-level clarity and speedier implementation under the new government.

“Under the draft EV policy of the government, there is special focus on expansion of charging infrastructure and we will ensure an adequate number of public charging stations to meet the growth of electric vehicles in the city,” he told PTI.

Sood said that the Power department is working to strengthen power transmission and distribution infrastructure in Delhi to meet the rising charging demand which is likely to rise with implementation of the new EV policy.

As a committed partner to the Delhi government's vision of a ‘Viksit Delhi’, BSES discoms have facilitated the installation of a “record” number of EV charging points in the last one year, said a BSES official.

“In 2025–26, BSES discoms installed over 1,600 EV charging points and battery swapping stations across 1,241 locations—the highest ever in a single year,” he said.

So far, the BSES discoms - BRPL and BYPL - have together installed over 6,500 EV charging points and battery swapping stations across more than 3,400 locations in South, West, East and Central Delhi, he said.

These include 3,217 (49 per cent) private charging points (2,273 locations), followed by 2,870 (44 per cent) public charging points (838 locations), and 465 (7 per cent) captive charging points (314 locations), while 340 battery swapping stations account for 5 per cent of the network, he said.

Under the private category, connections are largely domestic

connections which account for 50–60 per cent, RWAs or group housing societies 15–20 per cent, and commercial establishments 20–25 per cent, he added.

Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (TPDDL) discom that supplies electricity in North Delhi areas, has energised 3,783 EV connections as of now, out of which 1,641 EV connections got charged in 2025–26, said a company spokesperson.

The new connections include 42 for public charging stations and 15 for battery swapping stations, he said.

North Delhi areas, including Rohini, Pitampura, Civil Lines, Model Town, and Shalimar Bagh have emerged as key demand hubs, contributing to nearly 63 per cent of the total installations, while regions like Bawana, Narela, and Kirti present significant opportunities for future growth, he said.

“We aim to facilitate 3,000 additional EV charging stations in the coming year by providing the necessary power connections,” he added. PTI

NDMC schools open admissions for 2026–27 session

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has commenced the admission process for the 2026–27 academic session across its network of Atal Adarsh Vidyalayas. Admissions are open for students seeking entry into Classes I to IX, with registrations starting from April.

According to an official notice issued by the NDMC's Education Department, parents and guardians can apply for admission by submitting the prescribed application form available at respective schools as well as on the council's official website. The initiative aims to ensure wider access to quality education within the NDMC jurisdiction.

The Atal Adarsh Vidyalayas, known for their emphasis on academic excellence and holistic development, cater to students residing in the NDMC area. Authorities have encouraged parents to complete the registration process within the stipulated timeframe to secure admission for their wards.

CENSUS 2027: Houselisting phase kicks off in NDMC, cantonment areas

NEW DELHI: The houselisting and housing enumeration phase of Census 2027 kicked off in NDMC and cantonment areas of the capital on Thursday, with door-to-door listing and verification work progressing in full swing.

Around 570 enumerators were deployed in New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) and Delhi Cantonment Board areas, who mapped the houselisting blocks allocated to them, a census officer said.

“Around 200 entries from areas such as Chanakyapuri and New Moti Bagh have been received and enumerated so far,” he said. Officials said some residents questioned enumerators when they knocked at their doors, confusing the houselisting exercise with special intensive revision (SIR) related to electoral rolls. “However, we have already instructed the enumerators for caution in such situation and allay any fears expressed by people during houselisting,” the official said. AGENCIES

SEAMLESS EMERGENCY INTEGRATION IN FOCUS

Rising heat, rising alert: L-G reviews fire safety

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Thursday chaired a high-level review meeting on the functioning of the Delhi Fire Service (DFS), focusing on infrastructure expansion, manpower strengthening and proposed amendments to the Delhi Fire Service Rules, 2010, amid rising concerns over fire safety in the summer months.

The meeting, attended by senior officials including the Chief Secretary, Principal Secretary (Home) and senior DFS officers, also reviewed the department's Summer Action Plan. Emphasising preparedness, the L-G directed officials to maintain heightened vigilance in view of increasing temperatures and the associated fire risks. A key highlight of the review was the push for seamless integration of emergency services. Sandhu stressed the need for backend integration of Fire, Ambulance and PCR services under a common emergency call number, with co-location of these services in fire-prone areas. He underlined that simultaneous availability of these services is critical for effective response during emergencies.

Reviewing the proposed amendments to the Delhi Fire Service Rules, 2010, the L-G called for wide-ranging, citizen-centric consultations involving residents, traders and



Also visits Swabhiman Apartments

NEW DELHI: Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu inspected Swabhiman Apartments developed by the DDA at Ashok Vihar area and directed authorities to address the concerns of residents.

"In the spirit of citizen-centric governance, I interacted with residents who expressed their gratitude to the Prime Minister for these homes. They also highlighted concerns such as seepage, garbage mismanagement, irregular lift functioning in some towers, and issues caused by miscreants," L-G Sandhu said in a post on X.

Maintaining the integrity of such projects is essential to our mission of building a Viksit Dilli and Viksit Bharat. While this project is a model of transformative infrastructure, it must not be allowed to deteriorate due to poor maintenance, Sandhu added. **MPOST**

business stakeholders to ensure the framework remains practical and inclusive. He reiterated that regulatory systems must balance safety with convenience, promoting "Ease of Living" and "Ease of Doing Business" in line with national priorities.

The L-G also directed officials to expedite administrative restructuring plans, under

CM Gupta to launch 200 e-buses today

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta will flag off 200 additional electric buses on Friday, its third such launch this year, Transport Minister Pankaj Singh said on Thursday.

In a push for green mobility in the capital, the new government, since its formation, has launched around 2,184 electric buses into service, taking the total fleet strength to around 6,300 buses, including 4,538 electric buses and 1,759 CNG buses. "Delhi is rapidly transitioning towards a clean, efficient and future-ready public transport system. The induction of 200 electric buses and the launch of the Delhi-Rohatak interstate service reflect our commitment to sustainable mobility and improved commuter experience," Singh said.

In addition to service expansion, a new bus terminal at Madanpur Khadar near Kalindi Kunj metro station has been developed with essential passenger amenities, accessibility features for Divyang passengers, and sustainable elements, he added. An administrative building at the East Vinod Nagar Depot will also be inaugurated to enhance operational efficiency and staff facilities.

According to officials, a structured and time-bound fleet augmentation programme anchored in electric mobility is currently underway. Under this plan, Delhi's total bus fleet is projected to expand to nearly 14,000 buses by the financial year 2028-29, further reinforcing its leadership in sustainable urban transport. **MPOST**

Bomb threats: Z Security for Speaker

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Assembly speaker has been provided Z category security cover in view of the repeated bomb threat e-mails received by the legislative body in the last few weeks, an official statement said.

The move comes after the series of targeted bomb threats and a recent high-profile security breach, the Delhi Assembly Secretariat said. The secretariat and the speaker's office received approximately six to seven threatening emails since the budget session started on March 23.

There was also the recent



incident on April 6, when a man drove his vehicle inside assembly premises, breaking a boundary wall gate, and returned after placing a bouquet and a garland close to the speaker's office.

Under the new Z category

security detail, Speaker Vijender Gupta will receive 24/7 protection from a specialised team. The upgraded measures include a dedicated escort car that will accompany him all the time.

The speaker is currently provided with an armed personal security officer by the Delhi Police, officials said.

The Z category security cover comprise around 22 personnel, including personal security officers (PSOs), escorts, surveillance staff and around eight static armed guards. The enhanced security cover is typically granted to high-profile political figures, they said.

The Delhi Assembly premises are also undergoing a rigorous security fortification to ensure the safety of all members and staff in consultation with security agencies, the statement added.

A Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) quick response team with a vehicle has been stationed on-site to maintain a constant patrol within the Assembly premises and immediately act to neutralise any potential threats, according to the statement.

Further, automated boom barriers are being installed at every entry/exit gate to facilitate mandatory, rigorous checks for all individuals and luggage entering the complex, it added.

MCD to hold Mayor election on April 29

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) will hold elections for the posts of Mayor, Deputy Mayor and three members of its standing committee on April 29, according to an official notice issued by the corporation on Thursday.

The notice issued by the Municipal Secretary stated that the election will be conducted during the ordinary April meeting of the civic body at 2 pm on April 29 at the civic centre in accordance with the provisions of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 1957, and related regulations.

Nominations for the posts with a deadline of April 23 at 5 pm must be filed in the prescribed form, signed by the

candidate and two corporation members acting as proposer and seconder.

The mayoral post in the MCD follows a rotational system of five one-year terms; beginning with a seat reserved for women, followed by general, reserved and two general-category terms.

This year's election marks the fifth term under the current cycle.

In the first three terms, AAP councillors held both the mayor and deputy mayor's posts. In the fourth term, BJP councillor from Mukherjee Nagar, Raja Iqbal Singh, secured the mayor's post after AAP boycotted the election, helping the BJP return to power in the civic body after a two-year gap. **MPOST**

High-tech labs coming to 4 ITIs soon, says CM

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major push to align skill development with emerging industry demands, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has announced the launch of state-of-the-art, high-tech laboratories across four Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs), aimed at equipping youth with cutting-edge technical expertise in sectors such as power electronics, electric vehicles and advanced manufacturing.

The initiative focuses on both establishing new labs and modernising existing ones to bridge the gap between classroom training and real-world industrial requirements. Emphasising the importance of industry-relevant skills, the Chief Minister said, "These modern labs will not only enhance technical capabilities but also give trainees exposure to real-world industrial practices, opening up opportunities for both employment and self-employment."

At ITI Jahangirpuri, a dedicated Power Electronics Lab will be set up with advanced systems including PLC kits, VFD trainers, solar PV kits and



smart energy monitoring tools. The facility will train around 480 students across trades such as electrician, electronics mechanic and solar technician, with a focus on automation, renewable energy and electrical systems.

Meanwhile, the welder lab at ITI Jail Road (Hari Nagar) will undergo a major upgrade with advanced welding machines, simulators and fabrication tools. The upgraded facility is expected to benefit nearly 200 trainees by providing hands-on experience in modern welding techniques, improving both precision and safety standards. At ITI Arab Ki Sarai (Nizamuddin), automotive labs will be enhanced with cutting-edge Virtual Reality simulators for training in driving, welding and painting.

97.23% PASS: Delhi schools outshine national average

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood on Thursday highlighted the impact of sustained education reforms as Delhi government schools recorded a 97.23 per

cent pass percentage in CBSE Class X Results 2026, surpassing the national average of 93.70 per cent.

Congratulating students, teachers and parents, Sood underscored that the achievement reflects a deeper structural

transformation in the education system. He said, "This result is not a coincidence but a direct reflection of the empowering ecosystem built under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta." Stressing the scale of improvement, he added that it

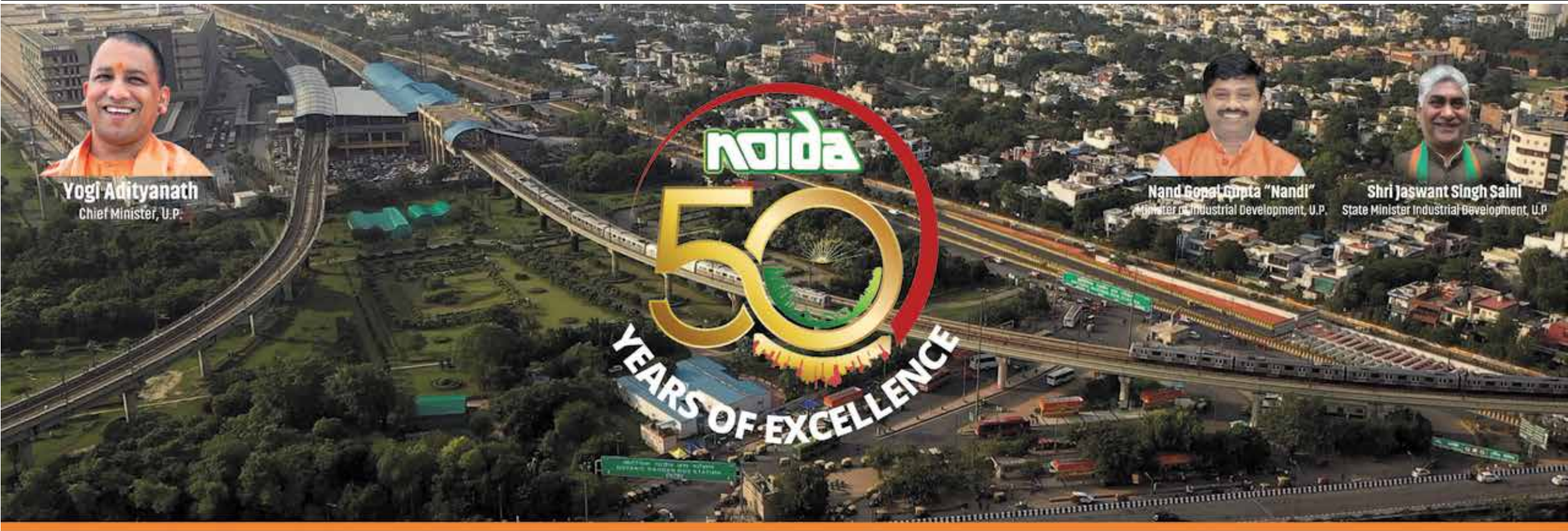
is "systemic and broad-based, visible not in select schools, but across the entire network of government schools in Delhi."

Sood pointed to a sharp rise in overall school performance, noting that 457 schools recorded 100 per cent results this year,

compared to 300 last year, while the number of schools crossing the 90 per cent mark increased from 529 to 924. He described this as clear evidence of a "system-wide transformation."

Highlighting student performance, the Minister said that

out of 1,88,460 students who appeared for the exams, 1,83,246 passed. He also drew attention to the growing number of high achievers, with 26 students scoring above 95 per cent and over 5,700 students scoring above 90 per cent.



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WIDE SPECTRUM OF ISSUES DISCUSSED

MEA briefs Parl panel on situation in Iran

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) on Thursday briefed the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs on the fast-evolving situation in Iran, with the discussions covering a wide spectrum of issues, including concerns over potential disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz, panel chairperson Shashi Tharoor said.

Describing the interaction as wide-ranging, Tharoor said the members of the panel used the opportunity to press the government on critical issues.

"It was a very good briefing with the foreign secretary on all the issues to deal with the Iran war that were not covered in the earlier briefing when he was himself not present. This time he gave us a comprehensive view. There were a lot of questions asked," Tharoor told the media.

The Congress MP said 17 members attended the discussions and all of them had very

Highlights

» Describing the interaction as wide-ranging, panel chairperson Shashi Tharoor said the members used the opportunity to press the government on critical issues

» The Congress MP said 17 members attended the discussions and all of them had very serious questions for the foreign secretary

» Asked if there were discussions on the situation at the Strait of Hormuz, he said: 'Everything was discussed, very much, that is a major subject'

» He added that India's relationship with 'every



single significant country in the region and beyond' was discussed

» 'Larger questions of strategy, energy security, geopolitics, Pakistan's role' were also asked

» 'The committee has felt very much that we are taken into confidence in the right sort of way and I think that we in turn

want to be constructive in our criticisms, questions and challenges to the government for ourselves as parliamentarians to represent the voice of the people of India. It has been a good exercise but we all agree that this is not something we need to talk about publicly,' Tharoor said

serious questions for the foreign secretary.

"But we do want to particularly say on record one of the things that many mem-

bers expressed -- a very high appreciation for the diligent, hard-working and courageous work of our embassy in Tehran and our diplomatic force

throughout the Gulf. It has been remarkable to see how much has been done by our people," he said.

"Our diplomats, the mil-

itary wing in the Tehran embassy, everyone has been doing a terrific job and I think the country owes them all a debt of gratitude," Tharoor, who himself is a former diplomat, said.

He added that India's relationship with "every single significant country in the region and beyond" was discussed and "larger questions of strategy, energy security, geopolitics, Pakistan's role" were also asked.

Asked if there were discussions on the situation at the Strait of Hormuz, the former Union minister said, "Everything was discussed, very much, that is a major subject."

"The committee has felt very much that we are taken into confidence in the right sort of way and I think that we in turn want to be constructive in our criticisms, questions and challenges to the government for ourselves as parliamentarians to represent the voice of the people of India. It has been a good exercise but we all agree that this is not something we need to talk about publicly," he added.

'COORDINATED ATTEMPT' TO DISRUPT LAW & ORDER

Cops link Noida violence to 'Pakistan-based' X handles

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: Police on Thursday claimed that two social media accounts, allegedly operated from Pakistan, played a role in fuelling violence during the April 13 labour protests in Noida over demands for a minimum wage hike.

According to officials, the X accounts — "Anushi Tiwari (Proud Indian)" and "Meer Ilyas Inc" — circulated misleading claims about multiple deaths during the protest to provoke workers. Inputs later received from X indicated that both accounts were being operated from Pakistan using VPN services. An FIR has been registered at Sector 20 police station in this connection.

Police commissioner Laxmi Singh described the unrest as a "coordinated attempt" to disrupt law and order, involving both online misinformation and on-ground mobilisation. So far, 13 FIRs have been registered, and 62 accused have



Police personnel conduct a route march in the aftermath of workers' protest, in Noida, Gautam Buddh Nagar district, Wednesday

PTI

been sent to judicial custody. Police have not ruled out invoking the National Security Act (NSA) against some of those involved.

Police are also probing the role of a group named 'Mazdoor Bigul Dasta', whose members allegedly mobilised workers and incited violence. Police said three individuals — Rupeesh Roy, Manisha Chauhan and Aditya Anand — created multiple WhatsApp groups using QR codes, each with over 800 members, including workers from major

industrial units such as Motherson and Richa Industries.

These groups were reportedly formed around 2am on April 10, shortly after Haryana announced a 35 per cent increase in minimum wages, which triggered demands for pay parity among workers in Noida.

Police said the trio had arrived in Noida on March 31 and held meetings with workers across industrial sectors. They were also present during the April 10 protests, when workers first took to the streets.

'Journey continues':

Vaishnaw on anniv of India's 1st passenger train

THANE: Railway minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Thursday marked the anniversary of the first passenger train in India by sharing an image of the historic Thane railway bridge and an early train.

The first passenger train in the country travelled between Bori Bunder (Mumbai) and Thane on April 16, 1853. Vaishnaw shared on X a collage image of the old train on the Thane bridge and an Amrit Bharat Express train with the caption "Journey continues..."

An official release issued by the Central Railway said, "An authentic archival image of the Thane railway bridge and an early train has been shared to mark 173 years of Indian Railways, ensuring that the historical narrative is aligned with verified records." Historians note that archival accuracy has long been a challenge with several misattributed or stylised images frequently doing the rounds in public discourse.

TAKEAWAYS

» The first passenger train in the country travelled between Bori Bunder (Mumbai) and Thane on April 16, 1853

» Vaishnaw shared on X a collage image of the old train on the Thane bridge and an Amrit Bharat Express train with the caption "Journey continues..."

Author and historian Rajendra Aklekar said the earlier picture in circulation of a train on the bridge was not the actual bridge as per the records. "The earlier picture in circulation of a train on the bridge was not the actual bridge as per the records. The minister's use of the authenticated image has corrected years of wrong narrative and finally set the record straight.

MPOST

US declines to extend...

Continued from Page 1

Licence permitting delivery of Russian crude loaded before March 12. That exemption expired on April 11. A similar waiver for Iranian oil, issued on March 20, allowed about 140 million barrels to enter global markets and is due to lapse on April 19.

These measures came at a time when roughly 20 per cent of global crude and liquefied natural gas flows through the Strait of Hormuz, a critical chokepoint affected by the conflict. US officials had framed the waivers as a temporary step to stabilise supplies and curb price spikes. Energy Secretary Chris Wright earlier described the move as a "short-term, pragmatic effort" to reduce fears of shortages, adding it did not signal a broader shift in US policy toward Russia.

India emerged as a key beneficiary during the waiver period. Reports indicate Indian refiners ordered around 30 million barrels of Russian oil under the exemptions, helping offset supply uncertainties. Data from the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air showed India's imports of Russian fossil fuels surged in March 2026 to about \$6.3 billion, making it the second-largest buyer globally. Crude oil accounted for 91 per cent of that total at roughly \$5.7 billion, with coal imports at about \$365 million and oil products at nearly \$194 million. This marked a sharp rise from approximately \$1.9 billion in February,

when India ranked third.

Indian refiners, including major private players, had briefly reduced purchases from Russian suppliers such as Rosneft and Lukoil earlier this year under US pressure before increasing procurement again during the waiver window. The period also saw rare shipments of Iranian crude reaching Indian ports for the first time in nearly seven years, reflecting New Delhi's efforts to diversify supply amid disruptions.

Historically, Iran was a significant supplier to India, at one point accounting for 11.5 per cent of total imports before sanctions tightened in 2018 and halted purchases by May 2019.

The waiver policy drew criticism within the United States. Senator Richard Blumenthal argued against any extension, stating on April 10 that the measure had provided substantial financial support to Russia's war efforts. Senate Majority Leader Chuck Schumer and other lawmakers also raised concerns, warning that easing restrictions risked undermining sanctions aimed at Moscow.

With the waivers now ending, Washington is expected to intensify its "maximum pressure" strategy on Iran while maintaining strict measures against Russia, potentially tightening global oil supply conditions once again.

Voters approved...

Continued from Page 1

Bengal is going for polls on April 23 and 29. The court clarified that if an Appellate Tribunal allows an appeal and directs inclusion of a person's name, that individual will be entitled to vote in the upcoming elections once the revised list is issued. Similarly, exclusions upheld by the tribunals will also take effect through the same process.

At the same time, the bench drew a clear distinction for pending cases. It ruled that persons whose appeals are yet to be decided will not be allowed to vote merely because their cases are pending. Allowing such claims, the court said, would create uncertainty and undermine the entire verification exercise.

Meanwhile, the court also noted that the revision process had multiple safeguards. Initial verification was carried out by judicial officers, and a further layer of scrutiny has been created through Appellate Tribunals comprising former High Court judges. These tribunals have already received over 34 lakh appeals and have been tasked with re-examining records, hearing parties and giving reasoned decisions.

Stressing the need for finality before polling, the court said the timeline ensures that genuine voters are not excluded while maintaining the integrity of the electoral process.

Disposing of one petition, the court said aggrieved persons may seek relief before the Appellate Tribunals, including urgent hearings where necessary.

From Page 1

Govt assures

He threw a direct challenge — oppose the legislation at your peril, as the country's "hari shakti" was watching closely, and history has not been kind to those who "opposed women's rights".

PM Modi said that the women's reservation Bill would not "discriminate" against anyone and would not be "unfair".

Three key Bills — The Constitution (One Hundred and Thirty-First Amendment) Bill, 2026, The Delimitation Bill, 2026, The Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 — have been introduced. The decision on these will be taken on Friday.

During his speech in Lok Sabha, the Prime Minister urged Opposition parties to support the Bill, while providing a "guarantee" that it would not lead to political benefit for a single group.

Allaying fears of some states over the delimitation exercise, particularly those from the southern and eastern regions, the prime minister said no state will be discriminated against under the move.

Modi also made it clear that the proportion of Lok Sabha seats in any state will not come down as a result of the delimitation exercise. "There will be no change in that proportion (of Lok Sabha seats) either, and the increase will also be in the same proportion," he said.

PM Modi said no one should remain under the illusion that they are giving something to the women of this country as reservation in legislatures is their right. As the mother of democracy, he said it is India's cultural commitment that women are given their due right.

Amid objections from the Opposition regarding the timing of the Bill and apprehensions of "haste", the Prime Minister said he would "guarantee" that the passage of the Bill guaranteeing

women's reservation would not be a "victory for one party". "This will be a collective success for everybody, the entire nation. This won't go down as a victory for any one party," he said.

Modi also said the ruling dispensation does not want credit for implementation of the women reservation law in 2029 and offered to give credit to the opposition.

"We don't want credit. I give you a blank cheque for claiming credit on passage of women quota Bill. If you want me to use the word 'guarantee', I use the word 'guarantee'. If you want me to make a promise, I use the word 'promise'. Because if the intention is clear, there is no need to play games with words," he said.

"Today, I have come to appeal to you that do not weigh this on political scales. This is a decision in the national interest. The women across the country and the world are watching us, and will see our decisions. But more than the decision itself, they will judge our intent. If there is any flaw in our intent, the women of this country will never forgive," he said while seeking cooperation of all parties.

Modi said when Parliament was discussing the women reservation legislation in 2023, people were saying, "hurry up".

"But it couldn't happen in 2024, because it can't be done in such a short time. Now in 2029, we have time. If we don't do it even in 2029, we can imagine what the situation will be like. The demand of the time is that we should not delay any further now," he said.

The prime minister said that in India's development journey, MPs have got an opportunity to make women part of decision-making.

When an opposition member tried to raise a point about welfare of the backward communities, Modi shot back, "I come from the most backward community, but it is my responsibility to take everyone along." He said women of the country can no longer be deceived by complex procedural excuses to delay progress.

Urging the members to aban-

don their blockades, Modi argued that three decades of obstruction using various technical tangles is more than enough time to reflect on past failures.

Modi said in the last 25-30 years, among the women who have won at the grassroots level in panchayat election systems, there is a political consciousness. "Earlier, they stayed quiet, understood but didn't speak. Today, they are vocal. Therefore, today, whichever side or opposition there is, those millions of sisters who have represented in panchayats, who have deeply seen people's joys and sorrows, they are agitated," he said.

The prime minister said women's participation in the country's parliamentary democracy is not just about numbers, but a commitment to democratic values.

Modi said today, in every sphere of life, women's power is enhancing the pride of the nation, raising the flag high. In every field, he said, the country's mothers, sisters, and daughters are doing wonders and hence with their involvement, India's strength is only going to increase further.

"I served as chief minister for a long time. My experience is that a commitment to resolving sensitive issues proves beneficial. As experience deepens, its strength multiplies many times," he said.

Lok Sabha on Thursday took up the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, and the Delimitation Bill, 2026, for debate and passage. According to the proposal, the strength of the Lok Sabha will be increased to 815, of which 272 seats will be reserved for women -- a total of 33 per cent.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Amit Shah

Shah sought to give a "practical interpretation" on delimitation even as the Opposition flagged concerns over Northern states benefitting from the exercise, while the Southern states lagging behind due to the mismatch in population growth over the

decades.

He sought to clear the air amid opposition attacks over the representation of Southern states and said the seats will be increased in proportion to the existing seats.

He said the number of Lok Sabha seats in the five southern states will go up from the present 129 to 195 seats while the percentage of power will increase from 23.76 per cent to 23.87 or almost 24 per cent.

"Lok Sabha seats in Karnataka will increase to 42 from the present 28; in Andhra Pradesh, the number of Lok Sabha seats will increase to 38 from 25; in Telangana, it will be 26 from present 17; in Tamil Nadu, the number of Lok Sabha seats will go up to 59 from the present 39; and in Kerala, it will be 30 seats from the present 20," he said.

According to the bill, the Lok Sabha seats will go up to a maximum of 850 but Shah explained that it was a rounded figure and the seats will remain at 816.

Explaining how the total number of seats in the new Lok Sabha is fixed at 816, he said it is exactly 50 per cent more than the existing number of seats.

Shah rejected the opposition's suggestion that the government will indulge in some kind of "mischievous" during the delimitation exercise, saying the NDA government has not made any changes in the existing law.

"The delimitation bill is exactly like the previous law brought by your government. There is no change, not even a comma or a full stop," he said.

Shah made it clear that all elections till 2029 parliamentary polls, including 2027 assembly elections in Uttar Pradesh, will be conducted under the present system as the women's reservation will be applicable only in 2029.

He also rejected the suggestion that the women's reservation bill has been brought up eyeing the next week's West Bengal elections.

The Home Minister also said the Samajwadi Party members were saying that they would place the demand for a caste census but he would like to inform them that the government had already

taken a decision to carry out the caste census and it would be carried out along with the population enumeration.

"Right now, the counting of households is underway and the households do not have any caste. If the Samajwadi Party had its way, it would determine the caste of households as well," he said.

The Lok Sabha on Thursday took up the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, 2026, the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, and the Delimitation Bill, 2026, for debate and passage.

Opposition alleges

government of delaying the process. Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav also joined the attack, accusing the BJP of "trying to make naari into a nara." He demanded that OBC and Muslim women be included in the reservation framework and alleged that the government was avoiding a caste census to deny rightful representation. "We are for women's reservation, but we are against the BJP's trickery," he said, warning that delimitation could alter the country's electoral balance.

From the Trinamool Congress, Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar called the Bill a "disguised" attempt to push delimitation and questioned why it was introduced during ongoing Assembly elections. She argued that if the government was serious, it should have brought the proposal earlier and pushed for 50 per cent reservation for women, noting her party already fields a higher proportion of women candidates.

Other Opposition leaders raised procedural and constitutional concerns. Congress MP Manish Tewari pointed out that delimitation has historically followed a Census, questioning the use of outdated data and the removal of safeguards. Shashi Tharoor said the party had "no problem" with immediate implementation of women's reservation

but opposed linking it to delimitation without wider consultation, especially given concerns from southern states.

Shiv Sena (UBT) MP Arvind Sawant questioned why the 2023 law had not yet been implemented, while AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi strongly opposed the Bill, calling it a violation of federalism. He warned that lifting the delimitation freeze would disproportionately empower more populous regions while reducing the voice of others, particularly in the South.

CPI(M) MP John Brittas cautioned that a sharp rise in the number of seats after delimitation could make legislatures unwieldy and affect governance, raising concerns about efficiency and balance.

Trump says

Secretary Rubio and Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Dan "Razin" Caine to work with both countries to secure a longer-term resolution. "They want to see peace, and I believe it will happen quickly," Trump said, adding that he hoped this would become the 10th conflict he had helped halt globally. Despite the announcement, the situation remains fragile. Fighting in Lebanon has continued in recent weeks even as a separate, tenuous ceasefire has held between the United States and Iran. Netanyahu has maintained that Israel's operations against Hezbollah are distinct from any US-Iran truce, underscoring the complexity of overlapping conflicts in the region.

Lebanon, for its part, has insisted that any further negotiations must follow a cessation of hostilities. It has also reiterated its commitment to disarming Hezbollah, a key demand that could shape future talks but remains highly contentious within Lebanese politics.

At the same time, diplomatic efforts involving Pakistan and Iran have gathered pace. Pakistan's Chief of Defence Forces, Field

Marshal Asim Munir, arrived in Tehran on Wednesday leading a high-level delegation that included Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi. His visit marks the first by a foreign military leader since a two-week ceasefire between the US and Iran was agreed last week.

Munir held discussions with senior Iranian leaders, including Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf and officials from the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps at the Khatam al-Anbiya Central Headquarters. According to Iranian state media, the talks focused on steps to end the ongoing conflict, the broader regional situation and prospects for stability.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi also met the Pakistani delegation and later said in a post on X that he appreciated Pakistan's role in hosting recent dialogue. "Our commitment to promoting peace and stability in the region remains strong and shared," he said.

The visit is widely seen as part of Islamabad's effort to mediate between Washington and Tehran following inconclusive talks held in Pakistan over the weekend. Those negotiations ended without agreement, with US Vice President JD Vance citing Iran's refusal to abandon its nuclear programme as a major sticking point. Tehran, however, attributed the breakdown to what it called "excessive demands" from the American side.

Sources indicate that Pakistan is working to bridge differences on nuclear issues, with discussions reportedly exploring third-party monitoring of Iran's nuclear programme involving multiple countries alongside the International Atomic Energy Agency. Further talks may take place in Islamabad in the coming days, as suggested earlier by Trump.

The broader conflict, which began after US and Israeli strikes on Iran on February 28, has disrupted global energy markets and trade flows. The current US-Iran ceasefire is set to expire on April 22, adding urgency to ongoing diplomatic efforts across multiple fronts.



BATTLE FOR THE BASTIONS



‘NO PM TRAMPLED STATES LIKE MODI’

‘Black law’: TN CM Stalin torches delimitation Bill copy in fiery protest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHENNAI/NAMAKKAL: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister MK Stalin on Thursday burnt a copy of the delimitation bill and dubbed it a “black law”, alleging it seeks to make the Tamil people “refugees” in their own land.

Stalin hoisted a black flag and burnt a copy of the Bill on delimitation circulated by the union government and raised slogans condemning the move, hours before the Parliament was to sit for a special session.

The CM burnt the copy of the Bill at Namakkal in western Tamil Nadu, where he is camping in connection with electioneering. “Poradavom, Velvum ondraga” (Let us struggle, win together) was among the slogans raised by Stalin and others clad in black.



MK Stalin burns a copy of the proposed Bill during a protest, in Namakkal, Tamil Nadu

Highlights

- » The CM burnt the copy of the Bill at Namakkal in western Tamil Nadu, where he is camping in connection with electioneering
- » The deputy chief minister alleged that delimitation was a weapon in the hands of the Centre to cut off the state’s political representation

betraying” Tamil Nadu, Udhayanidhi alleged that the Centre was thinking of implementing whatever it wished with the assistance of some northern states. He alleged the Centre wanted to cut down the representation of southern states in the Parliament.

“The soil of Tamil Nadu, noted for its self-respect will never bow before the BJP’s arrogance...let the fire --seeking rights-- lit by the party chief spread across India,” the Deputy CM said in a statement.

At DMK state headquarters Anna Arivalayam, under the leadership of party leaders RS Bharathi and TKS Elangovan party workers, clad in black, burnt copies of the delimitation Bill.

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee chief K Selvapurunthagai held a black flag

demonstration in Salem and condemned the Centre over delimitation.

Dravidar Kazhagam chief K Veeramani hoisted black flag and set a copy of the bill on fire.

DK is the ideological parent outfit of Tamil Nadu’s ruling DMK. Both the CPI and CPI (M), allies of the DMK, also joined the protest by hoisting black flags to mark their opposition to the delimitation exercise. In a statement, Stalin said: “Let the flames of resistance spread across Tamil Nadu. Let the arrogance of the fascist BJP be brought down. Then, the fire of resistance against Hindi imposition that rose from Tamil Nadu scorched Delhi. It quietened only after Delhi was forced to yield.” He was apparently referring to the anti-Hindi agitation in the 1960s in the state.

Harivansh set for unopposed re-election as RS deputy chairman

Opposition has decided to boycott the election

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Nominated member Harivansh is likely to be elected Rajya Sabha deputy chairman as five notices have been received in his favour and the opposition has not given any notice proposing its candidate.

The election for the post of deputy chairman will take place at 11 AM on Friday.

The Office of the Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha, had fallen vacant after the term of Harivansh ended on April 9 and Chairman C P Radhakrishnan has under Rule 7 of the Rules of Procedure and Conduct of Business in the Council of States (Rajya Sabha), fixed Friday as the date for holding the election.

The last date and time for receipt of notices of motions for election was 12 noon on Thursday. Sources said five notices of



Rajya Sabha chairman CP Radhakrishnan with Harivansh Narayan Singh

While leader of the house J P Nadda moved the first motion, which was seconded by S Phangnon Konyak, the second one was moved by BJP president Nitin Nabin and was seconded by BJP MP Brij Lal.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman has given another notice, which was seconded by BJP MP Surendra Singh Nagar and JDU MP and working president Sanjay Kumar Jha has also moved a notice which was seconded by RLM MP Upen-dra Kushwaha.

Another notice has been given by RLD MP and Union minister Jayant Chaudhary, which was seconded by Shiv Sena MP Milind Murli Deora in favour of Harivansh.

The sources said no notice of motion has been received from the Opposition before the stipulated time and accordingly the election of the deputy chairman is to be unopposed.

‘Disguised Bill’: TMC demands 50% quota, flags delimitation concerns

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The Trinamool Congress (TMC) on Thursday termed the Women’s Reservation Bill a “disguised agenda” and demanded a 50% quota for women, even as the Opposition claimed it had the numbers to challenge the government during voting.

According to sources, the Opposition bloc believes it can

muster around 165–170 votes in the Lok Sabha, factoring in conservative estimates and possible uncertainties in attendance. This includes support from parties such as the Indian National Congress, Samajwadi Party, Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam, and Left parties including Communist Party of India (Marxist) and Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist) Liberation.

The ruling National Demo-

cratic Alliance (NDA), however, is estimated to have the backing of 300–320 MPs, including support from allies such as the YSR Congress Party.

Despite acknowledging the NDA’s numerical advantage, TMC leaders said the issue goes beyond numbers. A senior party member alleged that the government’s push for delimitation is a “sinister plot” with long-term political implications. At the heart

of the Opposition’s criticism is the perceived link between the Women’s Reservation Bill and the proposed delimitation exercise. TMC leaders argued that enhancing women’s representation is being used as a “smokescreen” to facilitate constituency reorganisation.

During the Lok Sabha debate, TMC MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar described the Bill as a “disguised” attempt aimed at delimitation rather than genu-

ine women’s empowerment. She also demanded that the quota for women be increased from 33% to 50%. w“Our party already fields more than 33% women candidates... now our demand is for 50%,” she said, adding that the party maintains a significantly high level of women’s representation. It is reported that TMC has a 41 per cent women representation in comparison to some other parties.

Delimitation sparks debate on power, federal balance

Opposition parties, particularly non-NDA formations, have been vocal in their criticism

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: As the central government embarks upon an ambitious agenda to redraw the electoral map of India via legislation, questions hang over the constitution of the Delimitation Commission itself. It has also thrown up serious political issues about transparency, federal balance, and constitutional provisions regarding the Delimitation Bills introduced in the Lok Sabha on Thursday. The three Bills consist of the Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, the Delimitation Bill, and amendments to the laws concerning Union Territories.

The act confers on Parliament the power to fix the dates and data that would be used for delimitation; the current constitution provides that delimitation must take place after every census using the most recent information available. The new act, which

Key Points

- » the main point that seems to be quite controversial is the fact that it fails to define the Delimitation Commission
- » All India Trinamool Congress also showed apprehensions because of the growing concentration of power

has caused some worry about the potential for discretion in an area previously seen as being outside politics, addresses this issue.

Nonetheless, the main point that seems to be quite controversial is the fact that it fails to define the Delimitation Commission. Despite the fact that the relevant law gives details on how this commission is made up (including a sitting/retired

Supreme Court Judge as well as election commissioners), it has failed to give a proper constitutional definition of the new Commission which raises some questions over the very existence of this commission.

Opposition - non NDA parties - have been outspoken, mainly, those representing southern and regional parties. Countering the concept to give Parliament powers to determine the period and manner of delimitation, the Congress has accused the plan of compromising the constitutional balance of power. The party leaders claim that “the process of allowing a simple majority in Parliament to decide on the delimitation will erode the constitutional provisions” and refer to the lack of a defined structure of Delimitation Commission as “an important institutional lacuna.”

One of the strongest opponents from Southern India - Dravida Munnetra Kazha-

gam (DMK) - where the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu M. K. Stalin accused the central government of trying to punish those states that succeeded in limiting the number of their inhabitants. “If you take steps to check your population, you cannot reward yourself by getting more seats in the Lok Sabha,” Stalin said. On the other hand, West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee’s All India Trinamool Congress also showed apprehensions because of the growing concentration of power. They believe that the increase in the number of members of the Lok Sabha along with the increased power of the central government in the question of delimitation will definitely put the government in a better position.

“It is very clear that these changes are being made to ensure that the party in power gets its way,” said one of the leaders of the party.

Format C-1

(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases

(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018, of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)

Name and address of candidate : MITA BAG, Vill. & P.O.- Maigram, P.S.- Arambagh, Dist.- Hooghly, Pin- 712602, W.B

Name of political party : ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS.

(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)

Name of Election : LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY 2026

*Name of Constituency : 200, ARAMBAGH (SC) ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY.

I, MITA BAG (name of candidate), a candidate for the abovementioned election, declare for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents :

(A) Pending criminal cases

Sl. No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)
1	Judicial Magistrate, 3rd Court	Court case No G.R. No.- 772 / 2016,		Sections 448 /506/ 34 IPC Punishment for House-trespass & Punishment for Criminal Intimidation
2	Judicial Magistrate, 3rd Court	Court case No. G.R. No.- 1888 / 2016,		Section 365 / 506 / IPC Punishment for Kidnapping & Punishment for Criminal Intimidation

(B) Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences

Sl. No.	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.

Format C-1

(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases

(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018, of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation &Ors. Vs. Union of Indian &Anr.)

Name and address of candidate : NIRMAL MAJI, Vill & P.O. & P.S. - Amta, Dist. – Howrah, Pin- 711401

Name of political party : ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)

Name of Election : WEST BENGAL LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY 2026

*Name of Constituency : 201, GOGHAT (SC) ASSEMBLY CONSTITUNCY

I NIRMAL MAJI (name of candidate), a candidate for the abovementioned election, declare for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents :

(A) Pending criminal cases

Sl. No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)
1.	Ld. ADJ 3 rd Court, (Special Court) Barasat, North 24 Parganas, was transfer the record to special Court of MP’s & MLA’S Mayukh Bhaban, Bidhannagar, Kolkata	Special Case no. – 72/22 Arising from Complain Case No. 2022/2022 Dt. 13.06.2022,		Sections 406 /409/ 120(B) IPC. Criminal Breach of Trust, Criminal Breach of Public Trust by public Servant or by banker, merchant or agent, Criminal Conspiracy

(B) Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences

Sl. no.	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE
	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.

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EDITORIAL

WAGES WITHOUT DIGNITY

The eruption of violence on the streets of Noida this week was not an isolated rupture. It was the visible breaking point of a long-simmering crisis in India's industrial workforce—one that has been quietly building across factory belts from Barauni to Manesar, Surat to Panipat. What unfolded in Noida was less a spontaneous outburst and more an accumulated expression of frustration, where economic distress, institutional silence, and policy shifts converged. When workers take to the streets in anger, it is rarely because of a single provocation. It is because every other channel has failed. At the heart of the unrest lies a widening gap between wages and the cost of living. For millions of factory workers, particularly those employed on contracts, incomes have remained stagnant even as inflation—especially in essentials such as food, fuel and housing—has steadily eroded purchasing power. Data suggests that real wage growth over the past decade has been negligible, barely keeping pace with inflation. The promise that labour codes would rationalise wages and improve livelihoods has not translated into tangible gains on the ground. Instead, delayed revisions and uneven implementation have deepened distrust. When a worker's monthly income cannot reliably secure basic dignity, agitation becomes less a choice and more an inevitability.

Compounding this economic strain is the structural transformation of employment itself. The rise of contractual and fixed-term work has fundamentally altered the nature of labour in India's industrial ecosystem. Increasingly, factories rely on workers who have little job security, minimal bargaining power, and limited access to social protection. While fixed-term employment was introduced with the promise of parity in wages and benefits, its execution has often tilted in favour of employers seeking flexibility and cost reduction. For workers, this translates into a persistent state of precarity—where employment can end abruptly and rights are difficult to assert. The expansion of contract labour is not merely an economic shift; it is a reconfiguration of power within the workplace. Equally significant is the erosion of institutional mechanisms that historically mediated labour-capital relations. Trade unions, once the backbone of collective bargaining, have steadily weakened in many industrial clusters. Legal provisions have made union recognition more stringent, and the scope for strikes narrower. Meanwhile, tripartite forums such as the Indian Labour Conference, which once served as a platform for dialogue between workers, employers and the state, have remained largely dormant. In this vacuum, grievances accumulate without resolution. Without credible avenues for negotiation, the street becomes the only theatre where workers feel visible and heard.

Working conditions have further aggravated tensions. The extension of permissible "spread-over" hours to 10–12 hours a day, even within a 48-hour weekly cap, has effectively normalised longer shifts in several states. For workers already grappling with low wages, longer hours without commensurate compensation deepen the sense of exploitation. The dilution of thresholds for health and safety compliance in smaller factories has also raised concerns about workplace risks. When fatigue, insecurity and unsafe conditions intersect, resentment is not just economic—it becomes deeply human. Migration adds another layer to the crisis. A large proportion of industrial workers in hubs like Noida are migrants, disconnected from local support systems and often dependent on contractors for employment, housing and even access to basic services. The experience of the 2020 lockdown, when millions of migrant workers were left to fend for themselves, exposed the fragility of this arrangement. That memory has not faded. Instead, it has reinforced a lingering sense of vulnerability and abandonment. In such a context, even minor disruptions can trigger disproportionate reactions because they tap into deeper insecurities.

The role of communication—and its absence—cannot be ignored. In the digital age, mobilisation is faster, narratives spread rapidly, and anger can be amplified within hours. Reports of protests being coordinated through messaging platforms point to a new form of labour organisation—decentralised, informal and often beyond the reach of traditional negotiation frameworks. While authorities may view this as instigation, it also reflects a vacuum where formal representation has failed. When institutions do not listen, networks will inevitably emerge to fill the void. Policy responses, though swift in the aftermath, often appear reactive rather than preventive. Announcements of interim wage hikes or the formation of committees provide temporary relief but do little to address systemic issues. The deeper challenge lies in restoring trust—between workers and employers, and between citizens and the state. This requires more than incremental adjustments. It demands a re-engagement with the principles of fair wages, dignified work and participatory governance. Labour reforms cannot be reduced to regulatory simplification; they must also ensure that the benefits of economic growth are equitably shared.

The Noida unrest is, in many ways, a warning signal. India's industrial growth story has been built on the promise of employment and upward mobility. But if that promise begins to fray, the consequences will extend beyond individual factories to the broader social fabric. Economic expansion that sidelines labour welfare is inherently unstable. It breeds discontent that no amount of policing can sustainably contain. Ultimately, the question is not why workers chose the streets, but why they felt they had no other option. The answer lies in a combination of stagnant wages, precarious employment, weakened institutions and rising aspirations. Addressing this crisis will require a renewed commitment to dialogue, transparency and accountability. Because when the factory floor falls silent and the streets grow loud, it is not just an industrial dispute—it is a reflection of a deeper democratic deficit.

RISE

VOICES



G PALANITHURAI

THE WRITER IS A FORMER PROFESSOR AND RAJIV GANDHI CHAIR FOR PANCHAYATI RAJ STUDIES, GANDHIGRAM RURAL INSTITUTE

At a time when politics is marked by hostility, exclusion and naked power play, a women's movement in Tamil Nadu is attempting something rare: to redefine politics itself

GREEN

THOUGHTS



NIDHI SHANKAR

THE WRITER IS WORKING AS A JUNIOR RESEARCH ASSOCIATE AT THINK TANK, MOBIUS FOUNDATION, NEW DELHI

Without systemic adaptation, rising temperatures could quietly but decisively cap India's growth story

When Women Reimagine Politics

As electoral politics grows harsher and more exclusionary, women in Tamil Nadu are calling for a gentler but firmer alternative built on inclusion, democracy and moral courage

On March 28, the 7th Annual Day of a women's movement (Penn) was held at Chennai to chalk out a new course of politics as the politics of today is violent, vituperative, indecent, selfish, and cruel. The whole space is meant for men, and women go there, and if they have to be masculine in all their activities. If they profess a politics of women, they have to be silenced and sidelined. That we have seen in local governments. These are all the statements of the members of the movement. The mainstream of politics today is meant for women of the political families. There is no way they are different from the men of their families. Hence, this movement wants to pursue a new politics different from mainstream politics. This is their declaration. What politics they want to chalk out is the politics of love, inclusiveness, empathy, emancipation, empowerment, unity, sobriety through increasing the stature of women. In this process, the women collectives want to cultivate and practice equality and democracy in the family, organisations, and institutions wherever they are working and functioning. We know the Indian Social reality and it is totally against democratic values, as it is feudal, unequal in every aspect of society, not only between men and women but among the segments of the community as it is arranged in hierarchy observed by the women collectives. Since Indian women have enormous patience and endurance in order to keep the family values, the transformative process is slow, yet it is taking place. The women's collective wants fundamental transformation, but that transformation through the participation of women and men. It could be possible by raising the stature of women with this aim; steadfastly, they are working. The way politics is being practised in this country by the political parties, one can easily gauge that it will lead nowhere. Hence, the woman has to pursue and practice politics with a difference.



When politics turns cruel, it is citizens—especially women—who must reclaim it

We women, consciously aware of ourselves not as subjects or objects but as conscious citizens, have responsibilities and duties in the transformative process of society. As women, we have to pursue politics that is our politics, and it is women's politics, but it is for the whole of humanity. When parties are pursuing their party politics meant for power and wealth for party men and women, we, the women, have to perform our politics as women's politics meant for the whole society. But our politics is distinct, different, and unique by its objective, methodology, and pursuits. It is possible only through conscious preparation of women as women with knowledge about ourselves, our society, governance, and the process of development. In this process, we have to follow an alternative path in politics. It should be simple, doable, enjoyable, and easy to follow for everyone, as observed by them. They never appreciate any big things. Simple not only in politics, governance, and administration, but also in lifestyle,

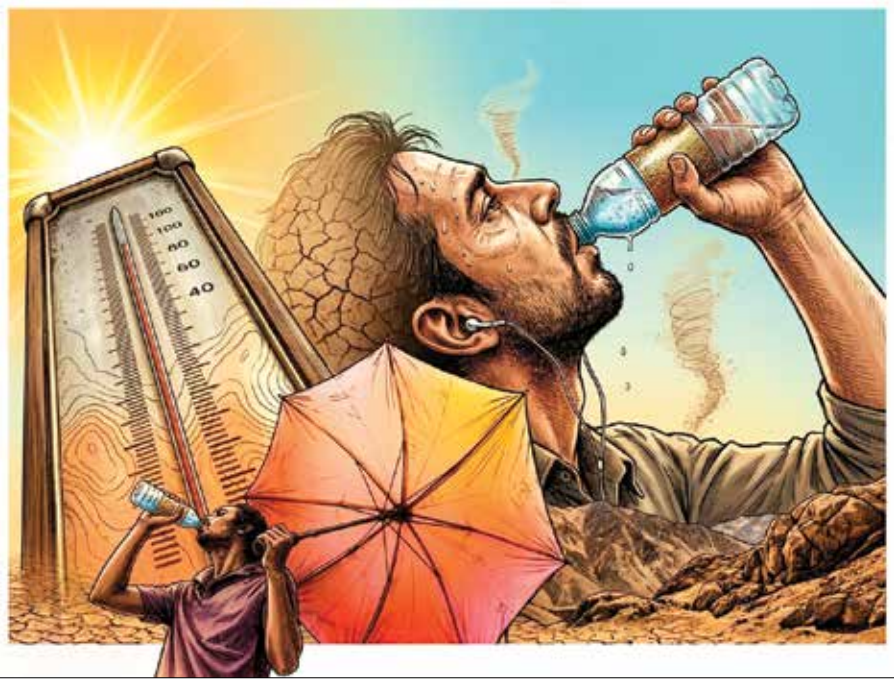
and is close to the poor, women, and nature. It is not for women alone; it is for human well-being. It has to cross gender boundaries. It is not power politics. It is the politics of empowerment and emancipation. In this age of divisive and hateful politics, we pursue a politics of love; we never hate. No negativity in our thoughts and actions. We have to cross ideological boundaries, and human values are fundamental for all our actions. All the women's actions are not oriented to capture power. But to make the power work for people. When we mean the poor, weak, meek, and the marginalised, including women. It could be done through the inner foundations of women. It is being done by a mentor who is not a conventional leader but a pathfinder and a change maker. Her leadership is not a ruler ship but a guide ship, guiding the women as a mentor. In this respect, this organisation is building up a women's movement in Tamil Nadu, which gives hope to many that, though the transformative process of the soci-

ety is slow, it will reach its destination in the near future through their continuous social action. In the above annual day meeting, I was invited to speak as a guest speaker along with many writers and popular speakers. While speaking to them, I informed them that Tamil society has carved out ethical foundations to be in public service and politics, as mentioned in a Chola-period Uthiramerur inscription. To be a public servant, old Tamil society fixed a series of ethical values to be followed by individuals to make them eligible to contest for any public office. But today we find politics without values and self-respect. As you all are aware, we have women poets and scholars in the ancient period. Today, in our practice of Western democracy, all the ills we find in our society afflict politics, governance, and administration. Contemporary politics is indeed bereft of all ethical principles, and it has reached its lowest ebb. In this context, what can an ordinary woman do to change the course of politics? It can be done only by organising women, keeping them together, showing them the non-violent path advocated by our leaders, with the instruments given by the constitution, democracy, rights, and responsibilities. The task is not ordinary. It requires a higher level of energy and consciousness. Since you have a mentor for your organisation, learn and shape your stature as an inevitable person. Work consciously to increase your stature wherever you are, in your family, in your community, in your panchayat, in the wards in town, and in the organisation. Through your activities, build a just family, a democratic family, a just society, from which decent politics will emerge, where masculinity will be subsumed in femininity, and thereby you can work for transformation. It could be done immediately through cleansing the vote bank politics. Plan a campaign for clean politics without bribing voters. Views expressed are personal

Cost of a Hotter India

Rising temperatures are no longer seasonal anomalies but structural risks—eroding productivity, straining agriculture and reshaping India's economic trajectory

India's seasonal climate is undergoing a clear and accelerating shift, with rising temperatures becoming an expected feature rather than an exception. According to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), Delhi witnessed an unusually early onset of heat, with February recording temperatures well above the seasonal average and an earlier-than-usual retreat of winter. An analysis by Down To Earth shows that 27 of 36 monitored Indian cities recorded above-normal daytime temperatures during the first half of February 2026. The city is now expected to reach highs of around 41°C in the latter half of April, as hot and humid conditions prevail across much of the country, indicating a broader climatic trend. Long-term data from the IMD also reinforces this trend. Ten of India's fifteen warmest years have occurred since 2011, with 2024 recorded as the warmest year, indicating a broader structural change in the country's climate system. The trend's implications are reflected by projections from the IMD, which forecast above-normal heatwave days from March to May this year. **Heat as a Structural Constraint on Productivity** Rising temperatures have a significant impact on labour productivity. Unlike many economic shocks that occur intermittently, heat imposes continuous losses, acting as a persistent constraint on economic activity by reducing work hours, particularly in physically demanding outdoor occupations, and thereby lowering income for daily-wage workers. By 2030, the World Bank estimates that heat and humidity could cost India up to 4.5 per cent of GDP (USD 150-250 billion) and contribute 34 million of the 80 million projected global heat-related job losses. India's labour market is highly vulnerable to heat stress due to its occupational structure: about three-quarters of the workforce ~ around 380 million workers, mainly in agriculture and construction, are exposed. India already loses over 101 billion hours of labour annually due to extreme heat. Heat stress gradually erodes productivity through shorter workdays and reduced physical efficiency, rather than sudden disruptions. Over time, the cumulative impact of these daily losses can become economically significant at the national scale, highlighting how climate change subtly undermines overall economic output. **Agricultural Vulnerability and Food Security Risks** Agriculture represents another sector where rising temperatures can have immediate and measurable consequences. Heat can reduce yields by accelerating crop metabolism, threatening both domestic supply and export potential. For instance, the hot start to March was flagged as potentially affecting key wheat- and rapeseed-growing regions during the critical grain-filling stage. As the world's second-largest wheat producer and a major edible oil importer, India relies on strong harvests to stabilise food prices and reduce import



India already loses over 100 billion labour hours annually to extreme heat

dependence. However, recent history highlights this vulnerability: in 2022, a similar spell of unusually warm weather during February-March damaged wheat crops and prompted an export ban to stabilise supply. The heatwave reduced wheat yields by 15-25 per cent (up to 32-34 per cent in parts of Uttar Pradesh) and caused vegetable losses of 40-50 per cent in some areas, according to ICAR. Lower harvests reduce farm incomes, weaken rural consumption, and increase the cost of essential food items. These indirect impacts rarely receive as much attention as headline economic indicators but play an important role in shaping household financial stability. **Climate Stress and Migration Dynamics** Another dimension of rising temperatures involves population mobility. Research examining the relationship between climate variables and migration has consistently found that changes in temperature and precipitation influence out-migration patterns, particularly in agriculture-dependent regions. Even a 1°C

increase has been associated with measurable increases in migration from rural areas. Heat stress reduces crop yields and income, prompting households to seek livelihoods in urban areas. This form of climate-related migration can generate complex socio-economic effects. Cities receiving migrants may experience intensified pressure on housing markets, transportation networks, water supply, and other forms of urban infrastructure. Labour markets can also become more competitive with limited opportunities in the formal sector, often pushing migrants into informal employment. Meanwhile, rural areas lose labour, weakening agricultural productivity and local economies, which can deepen regional inequalities and challenge long-term planning. **Health and Infrastructure Under Heat Stress** High temperatures can affect the human body through multiple physiological pathways, making heat stress a major environmental and occupational hazard. It is widely recognised as the leading cause of weather-related

mortality worldwide. Heat exposure can lead to worsening of conditions like cardiovascular disease, diabetes, asthma, and mental health issues, and can lead to fatal heatstroke. It also drives higher energy demand as people rely on fans and air conditioners, straining grids. While necessary for public safety and comfort, this increased energy consumption has environmental implications. Greater electricity generation, often from fossil fuel sources, leads to higher greenhouse gas emissions. A 2024 analysis found heatwaves raised peak electricity demand by nine per cent, increasing fossil-fuel generation and CO₂ emissions by 223 million tonnes. This dynamic creates a feedback loop in which rising temperatures increase cooling demand, which raises emissions and further accelerates climate change. **Policy Pathways for Heat Resilience** Addressing these risks requires coordinated action across sectors. Expanding urban Heat Action Plans in major cities, like in 2013, Ahmedabad developed South Asia's first-ever heat action plan with early warnings, cooling centres, and adjusted work schedules, to protect lives. Labour policies such as rest breaks, shaded work-sites, and hydration reduce productivity losses, while climate-resilient agriculture, including heat-tolerant crops, efficient irrigation, and insurance, stabilises rural incomes and limits migration. The early warmth at the start of the year, followed by intensifying heat in April, goes beyond a transient seasonal pattern. It points to deeper climatic shifts affecting economic productivity, agricultural stability, migration patterns, public health, and energy systems, underscoring the need for both immediate adaptation and long-term planning. As heat extremes intensify, policy pathways must move toward proactive, systemic resilience embedded across sectors. Views expressed are personal

TECH
DILEMMA



SUTIRTHA BHATTACHARYA
& DN PRASAD

S BHATTACHARYA IS CHAIRMAN OF WEBEL AND FORMER CHAIRMAN OF COAL INDIA LIMITED, AND DN PRASAD IS A FORMER ADVISER, MINISTRY OF COAL

Artificial Intelligence is no longer just a technological leap but an economic force, environmental challenge and ethical dilemma today

AI's Double Edge

As Artificial Intelligence reshapes economies and societies, its promise is shadowed by rising energy demands, ethical risks and widening global inequalities

The nuclear research facility, famously known as CERN, also the world's leading particle physics lab, made its World Wide Web code freely available in April 1993. The digital revolution took off. Then came the dotcom age and the infamous dotcom bubble burst, followed by coding and now Artificial Intelligence, or AI. AI is now a part of the common vocabulary like Internet, World Wide Web, digital presence, digital arrest, and hackers. The last two are impacting many adversely, posing a risk of exploitation to the digitally unempowered. Thus, AI is now a Goliath, but with enormous contradictions of hope, greed, and fear. Never before, perhaps, in the world has 'Artificial' impacted so much of the 'Real'. AI is perceived today as a miracle arriving at the doorstep, yet created by humans. The stock economy is, these days, driven by investment in IT, with AI taking almost the entire cake. NVIDIA became the first company to cross a USD 5 trillion valuation, with Apple breaching the USD 4 trillion mark. There is little chance that AI firms are driven by the spirit of altruism. The quest for more money is visible at the forefront of the AI economy, as we witness Amazon and Microsoft fighting it out over OpenAI.

AI's tremendous potential of arriving at the quickest but informed diagnosis, individual need-matching medicines, precision-enhancing surgical interventions, and many more on the anvil is



Unchecked expansion of AI raises urgent questions around sustainability, equity and governance

changing the landscape of medical and health management. Preventing human exposure in potentially life-threatening conditions, and helping in disaster recovery and management are some of the shining examples in AI's ever-inflating bag of achievements. The six questions of the world — which, where, when, why, what, and how — are currently sought to be answered by AI tools for people eager for answers. They say information is power, and now there is no need to second-guess where that power lies. But that very power requires

huge amounts of electrical power to empower AI data centres. The International Energy Agency (IEA) has estimated global electricity consumption at 415 TWh for data centres in 2024. This figure is likely to double by 2030. Water demand for cooling will also go up exponentially. This soaring demand for data centre-related power and water, coupled with mining of critical minerals to support the hardware for computer infrastructure, is leading to environmental and equity concerns across the globe. Some recent

studies have also thrown up worries of a steep temperature increase around data centres. AI's observed tendency of bias with the use of non-inclusive data is more beneficial to the host countries. It is also increasingly vulnerable to cyberattacks, data leaks, and data misuse, raising huge privacy concerns. Opaque algorithms followed are adversely impacting public trust, amidst fear of information manipulation. But indeed, there is hope. The voice for ethical validation of AI has been growing stronger. The need for regulatory oversight, including setting lower trajectories for Power Usage Effectiveness (PUE) and Water Usage Effectiveness (WUE), is now well recognised. The final solution may arrive somewhere between the EU's strong regulation and the USAs almost nil approach, without causing much headwind to the spirit of innovation. Falling prices of green energy and energy storage are making that energy route the ready solution for energising data centres. Modular nuclear is evolving into commercial technology, allowing isolated data centre powering. Reverse osmosis and recycling are being perfected to cater to the quality and quantity needs for water. With investments acquiring a new scale, doors are being opened for the advent of technologies like quantum computing, stable thermonuclear reactors,

and cooler, high-efficiency data centres requiring less power and water. Necessity, as the mother of invention, is playing out. But the debatable question is whether emerging technologies will make breakthroughs quickly, or whether, by then, less-than-hoped returns will drive away investments in AI, in turn reliving the dotcom nightmare. India, with a pool of institutions connected to strong data science, physics, mathematics, and statistics, can show the world a more humane, attainable path for AI development. Putting moderate AI regulation in place, building partnerships with countries possessing critical minerals, and creating economic zones for processing with attractive policy could make India an important player in the sector. Public investment needs to be consciously directed towards the sector, incentivising safe, ethical lifecycle AI. Today, Google's largest investment in a data centre outside the USA is all set to come up near Visakhapatnam. These investments are expressions of trust in India's prowess. If AI fails to pass the tests of ethics, equity, and safety, NPT-like treaties will take off to prevent rogue AI intrusion. But that carries the risk of exacerbating asymmetry among nations. The world needs to come together to facilitate the development and use of responsible, ethical, humane AI.

Views expressed are personal

DEAR EDITOR

CRISIS OF INSTITUTIONAL TRUST

The Supreme Court's recent observations on the transfer of over 1,000 officers in poll-bound West Bengal highlight a troubling institutional drift. While the court rightly refused to intervene in the immediate matter, its remark on the growing trust deficit between the state government and the Election Commission is deeply concerning. Elections in a democracy must inspire confidence, not suspicion. The large-scale, overnight transfers—especially of senior officials—may be within the EC's powers, but the absence of consultation raises legitimate questions about federal balance. Equally worrying is the court's candid admission that the purpose of All India Services is being undermined. When both the state and the poll body distrust each other's officers, the system itself appears fractured. Free and fair elections require not just authority, but credibility. Rebuilding institutional trust must become an urgent priority, lest the democratic process itself begin to lose public faith.

- ANKUR MAHAJAN, JALANDHAR

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Send your letters to letter2editor.mp@gmail.com. You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

HUMAN
COST



ADITYA GOLE

THE WRITER IS A COMMUNICATION PROFESSIONAL AND FORMER JOURNALIST

Across centuries, writers have dismantled the myth of war, revealing its human cost and moral emptiness in ways that politics continues to ignore

War and Words

From Homer to Brecht, literature has consistently exposed war's futility, urging humanity to confront its moral collapse beyond the illusions of glory and power

The blood-stained school bags reached Islamabad. The 'flight of dreams' boarded the 'flight of death' for that elusive peace in the boiling cauldron of West Asia. The world has seldom seen such a juxtaposition of bitter existential truths in a single breath as it did in the past 45 days. The West Asia war has tired out humanity. The ceasefire is hanging by a thin thread of sanity, left in the drying drip of political veins. Perhaps, these bloody times need literary radicals. Maybe as extreme as Aristophanes' 'Lysistrata', in which Greek women withhold sex from their husbands until the Peloponnesian War ends. A satire so incisive in its premise that it has never lost its bite. Today, world leaders are so busy mining the embedded 'laurels' of conflict that they have forgotten what literature has warned us through the ages — war is the ultimate expression of human failure. Let them revisit the library and reread that wisdom.

Literature, in the age of morphed utilitarianism, is often branded as a luxury of the privileged or a hobby of the sensitive. The Russia-Ukraine and US-Iran wars have proved otherwise. In 2026, it is a survival necessity — perhaps the last resort of empathy in a world which has mastered the art of destruction; perhaps the only force that can sensitise a generation into understanding the horrific failures of its ancestors. In Western literature, Homer's 'Iliad' is recognised as the first work of significance. It is invariably part of university syllabi across continents. It is a devastating war poem on the face and a deliberative anti-war poem in its soul. It is less about the victory of the Greeks and more about the weeping father kneeling before Achilles, begging for the return of Hector's desecrated body. It is about the overpowering realisation that the war's deepest wound is the one it inflicts on human dignity.

If we travel from Homer to the Bard, the words dig deeper, and the echo grows stronger. Shakespeare's plays were not overt manifestoes against war; they are even more enduring. The aftermath lies exposed so starkly that the illusion of glory cannot survive its truth. Let us appropriate 'Macbeth' for broader understanding. The decorated warrior of Scotland evolves into a monster with decaying morality, where ambition legitimises blood. In the struggle of ethics, the victor turns vanquished in the end. Even 'Henry V' appears to celebrate



War is not glory—it is the ultimate confession of human failure

martial heroism. The St. Crispin's Day speech is often read as a rousing call to arms, as we often encounter in Trump's press conferences, though a horribly watered-down version of it. But beneath it lies the unease of its rhetoric. The soldiers are laden with fear and uncertainty, not with glory and grandeur. Shakespeare's thesis is also evident in 'Troilus and Cressida'. The Trojan War becomes a hollow currency, reduced to a theatre of ego, absurdity and futility. The war is stripped of its drummed-up dignity, leaving behind only emptiness.

Tolstoy's 'War and Peace' is an epic meditation on war, where Napoleon's invasion of Russia fragments lives and ravages history. Andrei, who finds a way out of boredom in the adrenaline rush of war, realises its uselessness in the face of death. Pierre and Natasha, who emerge as dishevelled remnants of war, realise how collective stupidity and vanity destroy lives. Delusion often leads to catastrophe, and it becomes too late when the meaning of simple family life eventually dawns on humanity. As the US and Iran retrace from the brink of the Stone Age, hope lingers on them emerging as prison-breakers and not as prisoners of war.

The century we left behind has given humankind searing anti-war literature.

Wilfred Owen's words in the 'Preface to Poems' still echo in the corridors of tragedy: 'My subject is war, and the pity of war. The poetry is in the pity.' It was written from the trenches of the First World War. It is a telling statement of purpose — or rather, purposelessness. The glory of dying in war stands demolished. Even Remarque's 'All Quiet on the Western Front' unnerved many when a nineteen-year-old soldier realised that the glory of conflict is propagated by men who will never set foot in a war zone. The immediate analogy lies in Trump's mindless pressers from the cocoon of the White House, while its military is egged on to fight to Make America Great Again (MAGA). The ego unsettles the world and undoes its order. Remarque's impact has been so loud and clear that even a century later, its Netflix adaptation won four Academy Awards. The scene Karoline Leavitt, the White House Press Secretary, should introduce to Trump is where Paul Bäumer stares at an enemy soldier he has killed and understands they were never enemies. Paul fumbles through the man's pockets and finds letters, photographs and all the postcards of life that are painfully similar to his own. Yet, we are where we are. Schools are bombed. Children die. Militaries are drugged with ideals of expansive

colonialism. Politicians find new micro-phones for their old lies. No less is Francis Ford Coppola's Apocalypse Now, which writer and lyricist Varun Grover recently recommended on a film podcast. There is hardly a more psychologically honest portrait of how war treats a soldier who wages it. It denudes every civilising pretension until the whispered conclusion arrives — 'the horror, the horror'. Literature, with cinema in its fold, has been an unwavering loyalist of peace and non-violence. But the audience is debriefed in the long run by a mercilessly selfish world.

Salman Rushdie rightly put forth: 'Literature is the one place in any society where, within the secrecy of our own heads, we can hear voices talking about everything in every possible way.' But the larger question remains — who is listening to those voices? Literature is not the alchemist that can resolve frictions and unite factions overnight. Yet, it can raise its head of conscience and consciousness amidst the greedy murmurs of war and the economics around it. The global defence industry was worth 2.7 trillion USD in 2024, as per certain estimates. Weapon-selling lobbies exist across the globe; they are powerful and well-oiled. Literature does not have lobbies that can inject the futility of bayonets and bombs. But it can present the balance sheet of human cost over worldly profits.

War is always justified in the language of the future. It is sold as a solution to injustice and threat. The Americans did it in Iraq. They are doing it again in Iran. Literature had warned of similar blatant profiteering through wars in an interesting play written by German dramatist and poet Bertolt Brecht, titled 'Mother Courage and Her Children'. In the 17th century, Anna Fierling sold food and liquor to Swedish soldiers. She made profits from conflict and travelled across Europe with the army. But fate had a tale to tell. All three of her children fell victim to the same war she relied on for commercial gain. The question before our generation is whether we let this civilisational catastrophe run unbridled or walk into a library to read literature — not to pass an examination, not for the badge of honours, but to be better human beings. To identify with a character who is not us, to understand a war that is not ours, and to realise the disaster that can one day be ours. Let us not be nuclear giants and moral infants.

Views expressed are personal

WHO SAID WHAT

Gaurav Gogoi
@GauravGogoiAsm

The proposal put forward by Congress and major opposition parties is simple. 1) Implement Women's Reservation unconditionally without waiting for updated national census or seat delimitation. 2) Expedite the work of national census and ensure accurate representation of major and minor communities especially OBC, SC, ST. 3) Build a national consensus on delimitation so that our nation's integrity and its federal character is strengthened. The BJP should stop being over smart and mix up all three major issues. Stop trying to bulldoze an unfair delimitation and delay the caste census in the garb of women's reservation.

Yogendra Yadav
@_YogendraYadav

That's what I have been asking to all these source-based journalists: show me the provision in the bills that mandate or even allow proportionate increase for each state. The Constitution Amendment bill (changes to Article 55, 81, 82 et al) does away with the existing freeze based on 1971 census. The Delimitation bill (Clause 8.9) mandates the opposite: seats to be allotted as per the latest census (means 2011). So, the conclusion is obvious: fresh allocation to be done by Delimitation Commission will have to follow population share of 2011. Can anyone show any provision in the bills (not source or assurances) that refutes this reading?

NEARLY ONE-FIFTH OF THE GLOBAL OIL PASSED THROUGH HORMUZ

‘Over 10,000 US troops enforcing Iran blockade, but no ships boarded so far’

WASHINGTON: More than 10,000 American troops are helping enforce the blockade on Iranian ports, and while no ships have yet been boarded, the US military said Thursday that it is warning Iran-linked ships that it could fire warning shots or escalate to other force if they try to outrun the Navy. Thirteen vessels have turned around rather than confront a naval blockade that began earlier this week, Gen Dan Caine, chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, told reporters at the Pentagon.

Some Iran-linked or sanctioned vessels that have left the Persian Gulf through the Strait of Hormuz, the crucial waterway for energy shipments, have appeared to halt their movements, turn off their radio transponders or head back toward Iran's coast, shipping data firms say. Vessels that approach the blockade, which is being enforced in Iran's territorial seas and international



Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Gen. Dan Caine

waters and not in the Strait of Hormuz, are given a warning, Caine said.

"Any ship that would cross the blockade would result in our sailors executing pre-planned tactics designed to bring the force to that ship — if need be, board the ship and take her over," he said.

Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said "less than 10% of America's naval power"

is being used to enforce the blockade. The Navy has 16 warships — 11 destroyers, three amphibious assault ships, an aircraft carrier, and a littoral combat ship — in the Middle East out of a battle force of roughly 300 total warships.

Also supporting the blockade are refuelling ships as well as surveillance, reconnaissance and intelligence operations designed to give the Navy the

Highlights

» Thirteen vessels have turned around rather than confront a naval blockade that began earlier this week

» 'The Navy has 16 warships — 11 destroyers, three amphibious assault ships, an aircraft carrier, and a littoral combat ship'

latest information on the vessels it is encountering.

Restricting Iran's sea access is a global effort, Caine said, and US military assets in other parts of the world, including in the Pacific, would pursue vessels illegally shipping Iranian oil or trying to provide material support to Tehran.

Caine noted the congestion of the area around the blockade, likening it to a crowded

parking lot and US destroyers to high-powered sports cars. "There is a lot out there," Caine said. "It is like driving a sports car through a super-market parking lot on a pay-day weekend, with thousands of kids in that parking lot, as you attempt to maneuver through there to get to that ship that would attempt to run that blockade."

Meanwhile, the leader of Iran's joint military command has threatened to halt trade in the Gulf region if the US does not lift its blockade of Iranian ports. Even so, US President Donald Trump said the war in Iran was "very close to over" in an interview that aired Wednesday.

Separately, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent warned that the US is preparing to ramp up economic pain on Iran by levying secondary sanctions on financial institutions that do business with the Middle Eastern nation.

AGENCIES

Russian missiles, drones bombard Ukraine; 16 killed

KYIV: Russia hammered civilian areas of Ukraine with hundreds of drones and dozens of missiles in an attack that stretched for hours from daytime into the night, killing at least 16 people and injuring more than 80 others as terrified residents covered in their homes, officials said Thursday.

Russia launched nearly 700 drones and dozens of ballistic and cruise missiles, primarily targeting civilians, in its biggest aerial barrage in almost two weeks, authorities said.

Tetiana Sokol, a 54-year-old resident of Kyiv, said two missiles hit near her home and she took cover with her dog in the hallway as flashes lit up the night and windows shattered from the blast wave.

"On the third attack, everything broke, everything flew, we were shocked, we didn't know where to run. I grabbed whatever came to hand and ran away with the dog," she told The Associated Press.

"I still can't find the cats in the house; they climbed out somewhere, I don't even know. No windows, nothing,



A public transport station being destroyed by Russia's drone attack in Zaporizhzhia on Wednesday

AP/PTI

the dog is still walking around in stress."

Moscow's forces have hit civilian areas almost daily since its all-out invasion of its neighbour more than four years ago, with the regular assaults occasionally punctuated by massive attacks. More than 15,000 Ukrainian civilians have died in the strikes, the United Nations says.

The latest bombardment came in the wake of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy's 48-hour trip this week

to Germany, Norway and Italy in an urgent search for more air defence systems that can stop Russian missiles.

Ukraine has developed a significant domestic arms industry, especially in the production of drones and missiles, but it can't yet match the sophistication of U.S. Patriot air defence systems.

Ukraine's top diplomatic priority is securing allies' help to buy and build more and better air defences, Zelenskyy said this week.

AGENCIES

FORMAT C-1

(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases

(As per the judgement dated 25th September, 2018 of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs Union Of India & Anr.)

Name and address of candidate:: **MADAN MITRA, 32/B, DHIRENDRA NATH GHOSH ROAD, POLICE STATION – KALIGHAT, KOLKATA:700025**

Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOL CONGRESS (AITC)**

(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)

Name of Election : **ELECTIONS 2026 FOR WEST BENGAL LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY**

*Name of Constituency: **CONSTITUENCY NO. 112 KAMARHATI**

I, **MADAN MITRA** a candidate for the abovementioned election, declare for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents:

SL. No.	Pending criminal cases			Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences	
	Name of court	Case No. and status of case	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed
1.	LD. JUDGE SPECIAL COURT (Under PMLA), BICHAR BHAWAN, CALCUTTA	M.L. CASE NO. 7 OF 2021.	SECTION 3 OF THE PREVENTION OF MONEY LAUNDERING ACT. 2002 – OFFENCE OF MONEY LAUNDERING: WHOSEVER DIRECTLY OR INDIRECTLY ATTEMPTS TO INDULGE OR KNOWINGLY ASSISTS OR KNOWINGLY IS A PARTY OR IS ACTUALLY INVOLVED IN ANY PROCESS OR ACTIVITY CONNECTED WITH THE [PROCEEDS OF CRIME INCLUDING ITS CONCEALMENT, POSSESSION, ACQUISITION OR USE AND PROJECTING OR CLAIMING] IT AS UNTAINTED PROPERTY SHALL BE GUILTY OF OFFENCE OF MONEY-LAUNDERING. SECTION 4 OF THE PREVENTION OF MONEY LAUNDERING ACT. 2002 – PUNISHMENT FOR MONEY-LAUNDERING: WHOEVER COMMITS THE OFFENCE OF MONEY-LAUNDERING SHALL BE PUNISHABLE WITH RIGOROUS IMPRISONMENT FOR A TERM WHICH SHALL NOT BE LESS THAN THREE YEARS BUT WHICH MAY EXTEND TO SEVEN YEARS AND SHALL ALSO BE LIABLE TO FINE.	NA	NA
2.	IN THE COURT OF THE LEARNED SPECIAL JUDGE, (CBI), BICHAR BHAWAN, KOLKATA	C B I / A C B / K O L K A T A - R C 0 1 0 2 0 1 7 A0010	SECTION 120(B) -PUNISHMENT FOR CRIMINAL CONSPIRACY AND SECTION 7 THE PREVENTION OF CORRUPTION ACT, 1988 – PUBLIC SERVANT TAKING GRATIFICATION OTHER THAN LEGAL REMMUNERATION IN RESPECT OF AN OFFICIAL ACT; SECTION 13 (2) R/W 13(1)(a) AND 13(1)(d) THE PREVENTION OF CORRUPTION ACT, 1988 – CRIMINAL MISCONDUCT BY A PUBLIC SERVANT.		
3.	IN THE COURT OF THE LEARNED ADDITIONAL CHIEF JUDICIAL MAGISTRATE AT ALIPORE	CBI SPE SCB SIT KOLKATA CASE NO. RC-04/S/2014	SECTION 120(B) -PUNISHMENT FOR CRIMINAL CONSPIRACY, SECTION 420 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 - CHEATING AND DISHONESTLY INDUCING DELIVERY OF PROPERTY, SECTION 409 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 - CRIMINAL BREACH OF TRUST BY PUBLIC SERVANT OR BY BANKER, MERCHANT OR AGENTS; SECTION 4 OF THE PRIZE CHITS AND MONEY CIRCULATION SCHEME (BANNING) ACT 1978 – PENALTY FOR CONTRAVENING THE PROVISIONS OF SECTION 3 OF THE PRIZE CHITS AND MONEY CIRCULATION SCHEME (BANNING) ACT 1978 AND SECTION 6 OF THE PRIZE CHITS AND MONEY CIRCULATION SCHEME (BANNING) ACT 1978 – OFFENCE BY COMPANIONS (1), 2 (a, b).		
4.	IN THE COURT OF THE LEARNED 9 TH JUDICIAL MAGISTRATE ALIPORE	GR CASE NO. 2562 OF 2002	SECTION 283 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 – DANGER OR OBSTRUCTION IN PUBLIC WAY OR LINE OF NAVIGATION.		
5.	IN THE COURT OF THE LEARNED 7 TH METROPOLITAN MAGISTRATE KOLKATA	GR CASE NO. 3900 OF 1999	SECTION 353 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860- ASSAULT OR CRIMINAL FORCE TO DETER A PUBLUIC SERVANT FROM DISCHARGE OF HIS DUTY AND SECTION 506 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 – PUNISHMENT FOR CRIMINAL INTIMIDATION		
6.	IN THE COURT OF THE LEARNED 9 TH JUDICIAL MAGISTRATE, ALIPORE	GR CASE NO. 1543 OF 1998	SECTION 147 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 - PUNISHMENT FOR RIOTING, SECTION 148 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 - RIOTING ARMED WITH DEADLY WEAPON, SECTION 149 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860- EVERY MEMBER OF UNLAWFUL ASSEMBLY GUILTY OF OFFENCE COMMITTED IN PROSECUTION OF COMMON OBJECT, SECTION 448 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 -PUNISHMENT FOR HOUSE-TRESSPASS, SECTION 427 OF THE INDIAN PENAL CODE 1860 -MISCHIEF CAUSING DAMAGE TO THE AMOUNT OF FIFTY RUPEES, AND SECTION 3 OF THE PREVENTION OF DAMAGE TO PUBLIC PROPERTY ACT, 1984 - MISCHIEF CAUSING DAMAGE TO PUBLIC PROPERTY.		

*In the case of election to council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.

AMID GLOBAL TENSIONS

Prime Minister Modi asserts military conflict cannot solve problems

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The world is going through a “very tense” situation impacting all nations, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Thursday, pitching for bringing lasting peace to Ukraine and West Asia as military conflict cannot solve any problem.

Modi made the remarks after holding wide-ranging talks with Austria’s Federal Chancellor Christian Stocker that focused on significantly ramping up bilateral ties in areas of trade, defence and infrastructure.

In their talks, Modi and Stocker extensively deliberated on the consequences of the conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine on global economy and vowed to work jointly to mitigate them.

The Austrian Chancellor landed in New Delhi on Tuesday on a four-day trip. It is Stocker’s first official trip outside Europe and first trip by an Austrian Chancellor to India after four decades.

“The entire world is going through a very serious and tense situation today. And it is affecting all of us,” Modi said in his media statement.

“In such a tense global environment, India and Austria are unanimous that military conflict cannot solve problems. Whether in Ukraine or West Asia, we support a stable, sustainable, and lasting peace,” he said.

“We also agree that reform of global institutions is essential to address growing global challenges. And eradicating terrorism is our shared commitment,” Modi noted.

Following the Modi-Stocker talks, the two sides signed six



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, right, and Austria’s Chancellor Christian Stocker ahead of their meeting at Hyderabad House, in New Delhi, Thursday

HIGHLIGHTS

» PM Modi made the remarks after holding wide-ranging talks with Austria’s Federal Chancellor Christian Stocker

» Modi and Stocker extensively deliberated on the consequences of the conflicts in West Asia and Ukraine on global economy and vowed to work jointly to mitigate them

agreements including one on setting up a fast track mechanism to help Indian and Austrian companies wanting to invest in each other’s economies.

Another pact was signed on cooperation on military matters.

The letter of intent (LoI) on military cooperation will provide an institutional framework for promoting cooperation building on the momentum of the India-EU defence and security partnership signed in January.

India and Austria also signed a LoI to advance counter terrorism cooperation including to facilitate establishing a joint working group on counter terrorism.

In his remarks, Stocker said the India-Australia bilateral trade has been growing “very

positively” and noted that the India-EU free trade pact will further enhance the economic engagement between the two sides.

The Austrian Chancellor, referring to the West Asia crisis, said “stability, trust, and reliable” partnerships are crucial to navigate the challenging time.

“At a time when geopolitical challenges are getting stronger, such partnerships are even more valuable. Together, we represent an international order in which we can live in freedom and security. We are in favour of a rules based world order,” he said.

Modi said Stocker’s visit is “extremely significant” and referred to involvement of Austrian companies in numerous engineering projects in India including in railways as well as clean energy initiatives.

Fire at Lucknow slum: Two children dead, more than 1,200 huts gutted

Devastating fire sweeps through an illegal settlement on Wednesday

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Two children have been confirmed dead in a devastating fire that swept through an illegal settlement in Vikasnagar Sector 12 along Ring Road on Wednesday evening. The victims, identified as Ayushi and Swati, were among six children reported missing after the blaze. The confirmation of their deaths has left families inconsolable.

The fire spread rapidly, engulfing nearly 1,200 huts within a short span. Around 100 LPG cylinders kept inside the shanties exploded one after another, intensifying the blaze and triggering panic across the area. Residents ran for their lives as flames leapt from one hut to another.

A total of 22 fire tenders were pressed into service and



People collect their belongings amid charred remains following a fire incident a day earlier, in Lucknow on Thursday

firefighting operations continued till around 10 pm. Authorities said the search for the remaining missing children continued late into the night.

According to officials, the settlement had come up over nearly three bighas of vacant land near the Mini Stadium

in Vikasnagar, where around 250 families had been living in makeshift huts for years. The fire reportedly broke out around 5 pm in a hut resembling a small mosque. Locals initially tried to douse the flames but failed.

Residents alleged that calls to

LAST BODY FOUND

Mathura boat capsizes: Death toll climbs to 16

MATHURA: The death toll in the Vrindavan boat capsizing incident has risen to 16 after the body of the final missing pilgrim was recovered from the Yamuna river, police said on Thursday.

Superintendent of Police (Rural) Suresh Chandra Rawat said the body of Pankaj Malhotra (40), a resident of Jalalabad in Punjab’s Fazilka, was found beneath the Panigat bridge following an intensive week-long search operation.

With the recovery, all pilgrims who had gone missing after the incident have now been accounted for, he said.

Malhotra, who worked as a manager in a steel factory in Himachal Pradesh’s Kangra, was part of

a group of pilgrims from Jagraon in Ludhiana.

A total of 16 pilgrims have died in the incident, while eight others who were injured have been discharged after treatment, officials said. The accident occurred on April 10 when the boat, ferrying pilgrims, capsized after colliding with a pontoon structure near Keshi Ghat.

Meanwhile, District Magistrate Chandra Prakash Singh has already ordered a magisterial inquiry into the incident and tasked Additional District Magistrate (Finance and Revenue) Pankaj Kumar Verma with ascertaining the cause of the accident and any lapses in safety measures.

Cleanliness drive across Haryana ULBs from May 1: CM

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday announced that a special cleanliness drive will be undertaken in all urban local bodies across the state for two weeks starting May 1.

Apart from this campaign, ward committee members will play a vital role in maintaining cleanliness throughout the year, he said.

Saini said that all the members must understand their responsibility and work towards achieving the vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s ‘Swachh Bharat Mission’.

Wards performing exceptionally well in cleanliness will be ranked and rewarded with incentives, he said while interacting with members of newly formed ward committees of urban local bodies through video conferencing from Chandigarh.

Congratulating the members, the chief minister said an effective sanitation system is only possible with public participation.

He emphasised that unless every individual takes personal responsibility for cleanliness, the mission cannot be accomplished.

He urged committee members to coordinate with waste collection contractors in their respective areas and ensure proper route planning so that garbage collection vehicles reach every household on time.

Saini also encouraged members to provide suggestions for improving the cleanliness campaign, stating that good suggestions would be considered and implemented.

He described ward committee members as a bridge between the public and the government and urged members to spread awareness about cleanliness among citizens.

Noting that gradual behavioral change would lead to greater public participation, he advised the members to educate and gently discourage people from littering at undesignated places.

Census-2027 Phase-1: Haryana CM launches self-enumeration facility

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday formally launched the self-enumeration facility under the first phase of the nationwide Census exercise in the state and said the Census is not only a statistical exercise but also the foundation for policies, welfare schemes and development planning.

The chief minister completed his self-enumeration on the occasion here by filling out the form online. He conveyed a message to citizens through this initiative to actively participate in the Census exercise.

While launching the self-enumeration facility under the first phase of Census 2027, he said the process is simple, secure and time-saving.



He emphasised that Census 2027 is a significant step towards realising the vision of a ‘Viksit Haryana-Viksit Bharat’ and is not merely a data collection exercise.

He urged people to provide accurate information, as the data collected plays a vital role in planning and development activities.

Notably, since the formation of Haryana in 1966, this will be the sixth Census for the state.

Saini said that the first phase of the Census in Haryana will be conducted from May 1 to May 30, during which house listing and housing census will be carried out. Before this, the facility of self-enumeration has been made available to citizens from April 16 to April 30.

He said that accurate and reliable census data is essential for designing policies and schemes that effectively reach every section of society.

Weak monsoon forecast adds to farm stress

Dealers promoting costlier ‘drought-resistant’ seeds as monsoon worries mount

AAISHA SABIR

NEW DELHI: A recent report by the India Meteorological Department (IMD) projecting a weak monsoon at around 92 per cent of normal rainfall has begun to push up crop insurance costs, raising fresh concerns among farmers ahead of the sowing season.

Insurers have moved quickly to reassess risks. Lower rainfall typically leads to reduced crop yields, which in turn results in higher insurance claims. As a result, premiums for vulnerable crops such as pulses, soybean and edible oils are being revised upwards. In central India, farmers insuring soybean may have to pay 15–20 per cent more this year.

On the ground, the impact is already visible. Rajesh Kumar, who operates an insurance counter in a village in Madhya Pradesh, said farmers are increasingly enquiring about coverage following the monsoon forecast. However, he has had to inform them that premiums are set to rise, adding to their financial burden.

KEY POINTS

» In central India, farmers insuring soybean may have to pay 15–20 per cent more this year

» Warehouses are steadily filling up with pulses, edible oil and rice—not as a sign of hoarding, but as a calculated business move

» With forecasts pointing to a weak monsoon, traders expect smaller harvests and tighter supplies, which typically push prices higher



» Regions expected to receive below-normal rainfall—such as parts of central India, Jharkhand and Bihar—could face crop losses and rising prices

» While a soybean farmer in Vidarbha may suffer losses, a rice grower in Assam could see a relatively stable season. Such disparities create supply imbalances

typically push prices higher. Seed companies and fertiliser dealers are also responding to the outlook. Many are promoting costlier “drought-resistant” seed varieties that can better withstand poor rainfall.

While these may offer some protection against weather risks, they add to the financial strain on farmers already operating on thin margins.

Suresh, a farmer in Maha-

rashtira, faced this dilemma while purchasing seeds in April. His dealer recommended a new, more expensive variety, claiming it was better suited for dry conditions. “He wasn’t wrong,” Suresh said, “but I can’t afford to spend an extra Rs 2,000 right now.”

Like him, many farmers are left with limited options. Some opt for cheaper seeds and rely on favourable

weather, while others shift to short-duration crops that can mature quickly even with limited rainfall. These are often decisions driven by survival rather than optimal planning.

Regions expected to receive below-normal rainfall—such as parts of central India, Jharkhand and Bihar—could face crop losses and rising prices. The impact, however, is uneven. While a soybean farmer in Vidarbha may suffer losses, a rice grower in Assam could see a relatively stable season. Such disparities create supply imbalances.

“Regional shortages often translate into nationwide price pressures,” an Agriculture department official said. “A weak monsoon in a key producing belt can affect food costs across India.”

Market players say price movements often begin even before crops are harvested. “People assume prices rise after a poor harvest,” said a Delhi-based pulse distributor. “In reality, markets react to forecasts. By the time the monsoon ends, prices may have already increased by 8–15 per cent.”

Bageshwar Dham gets nod to receive foreign funds

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Home Affairs has granted the registration of Shri Bageshwar Jan Seva Samiti, under the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA), making the religious organisation eligible to receive foreign funds.

The samiti, led by preacher Dharendra Krishna Shastri, is described as a religious, cultural, economic, educational, and social organisation. The Bageshwar Dham website lists the samiti as the account holder, through which people can contribute to support it. The organisation is one of the 38 organisations, including Ramakrishna Math Bolpur, Sri Ramakrishna Sharada Ashrama in Karnataka, Ramkrishna Math in Pune, Shikhar Dhawan Foundation, NIIT Foundation, and HCL Foundation, among others, that were cleared by the ministry for receiving foreign funds this year.

Punjab CM unveils Rs 177 crore projects in Batala, targets rivals

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Thursday unveiled development projects worth Rs 177 crore in Batala, signalling a major infrastructure push while launching a sharp political attack on previous regimes.

The package includes works worth Rs 95.72 crore by the municipal corporation, Rs 16.05 crore by the Mandi Board, and Rs 65.09 crore for road construction by the Public Works Department, along with additional repair works. Key projects include new bridges, a modern bus stand to ease congestion, and Rs 14.81 crore for new police lines.

Calling the initiative a “decisive break from the past,” Mann said people had rejected “decades of misrule” in 2022



and would not allow a return to it. He accused previous governments of weakening laws related to sacrilege (beadbi) cases to shield offenders.

Highlighting legislative action, Mann said the state has passed the Jaagat Jot Sri Guru Granth Sahib Satkar (Amendment) Bill, 2026, pro-

viding stricter punishment for such offences. “No one guilty of this unpardonable act will be spared,” he asserted.

The Chief Minister also took aim at Opposition parties, particularly the Shiromani Akali Dal, alleging corruption, patronage of drug networks, and a disconnect from public concerns. He criticised their campaigns as politically motivated and rejected their claims of safeguarding Punjab.

On governance, Mann highlighted key welfare measures, including 300 units of free electricity for households, daytime power supply for farmers, and over 65,000 government jobs for youth. He said the state has also saved Rs 1,462 crore through resumed coal supply from Pachwara mines.

PUNJAB’S ‘YUDH NASHEAN VIRUDH’ SEES RESULTS

Community policing powers Faridkot’s drug crackdown

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: As Punjab intensifies its ‘Yudh Nashean Virudh’ (war against drugs) campaign, Faridkot district is emerging as a model for how community-led policing can deliver measurable results in tackling the state’s deep-rooted drug crisis.

Spearheaded by Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann, the campaign has begun to show visible impact on the ground, with a noticeable decline in both drug trafficking and consumption in the district. Officials attribute this shift to a strategy that blends strict enforcement with active citizen participation, moving beyond conventional policing methods.

At the heart of Faridkot’s success is an innovative anonymous reporting system.

INSIGHT

» Spearheaded by CM Bhagwant Mann, the campaign has begun to show visible impact on the

ground

» There has been a noticeable decline in both drug trafficking and consumption in the district

Residents have been sharing information about drug peddlers and substance abuse through handwritten notes, allowing them to remain unidentified. This simple mechanism has helped overcome fear and hesitation, generating consistent grassroots intelligence that has enabled police to carry out targeted crackdowns on local drug networks.

Alongside enforcement, the district administration has rolled out ‘Mission Nishchay’ at the village level to curb both supply and demand. Awareness campaigns, coupled with

youth engagement initiatives such as sports tournaments and distribution of sports kits, are encouraging young people to stay away from drugs and participate in constructive activities.

The combined approach is yielding tangible outcomes. Areas once known for open drug trade are witnessing reduced activity, while public spaces are being reclaimed by residents. Women and families, locals say, now feel safer stepping out even after dark—an indication of improving ground conditions.

Another key indicator of change is the sharp decline in demand for intoxicating substances. Chemists in Faridkot report an 80–90 per cent drop in sales of addictive tablets and injections over the past year, pointing to a significant behavioural shift within the community.

The government has also emphasised rehabilitation, ensuring that individuals struggling with addiction are connected to de-addiction centres and supported through supervised care at home.

Senior Superintendent of Police Pragya Jain said community participation has been central to the progress. “The fight against drugs cannot be won by policing alone. When citizens share responsibility, both supply and demand begin to collapse,” she noted.

Nation Briefs

AMBEDKAR JAYANTI OBSERVED AT ECR HQ

HAJIPUR: A grand function was organised at the Vaishali Rail Auditorium of East Central Railway headquarters on April 16 to mark the birth anniversary of B. R. Ambedkar. General Manager Chhatrasal Singh paid floral tribute to Ambedkar’s portrait, joined by senior officials, union representatives, and members of the SC/ST Association. Addressing the gathering, Singh said Ambedkar dedicated his life to equality, justice and social harmony. He noted that the day is also observed as Equality Day and Knowledge Day worldwide. Singh highlighted that Ambedkar’s Constitution laid the foundation of India’s vibrant democracy and contributed significantly to economic reforms, women’s empowerment and social progress.



J&K: GOC WHITE KNIGHT CORPS REVIEWS SECURITY SITUATION IN RAJOURI

JAMMU: The General Officer Commanding of Jammu-based White Knight Corps, Lt Gen P K Mishra, on Thursday visited Romeo Force in J&K’s Kalakote belt in Rajouri district to review the prevailing security environment and assess the operational preparedness of troops. “GoC White Knight Corps, along with GoC Counter Insurgency Force Romeo, visited the general area of Kalakote to review the prevailing security environment and assess the operational preparedness of troops,” the White Knight Corps said on X.

Markets end lower dragged by banking and financial stocks

The two key indices — Sensex & Nifty had surged by more than 1 per cent on Wednesday following easing geopolitical tensions

OUR CORRESPONDENT

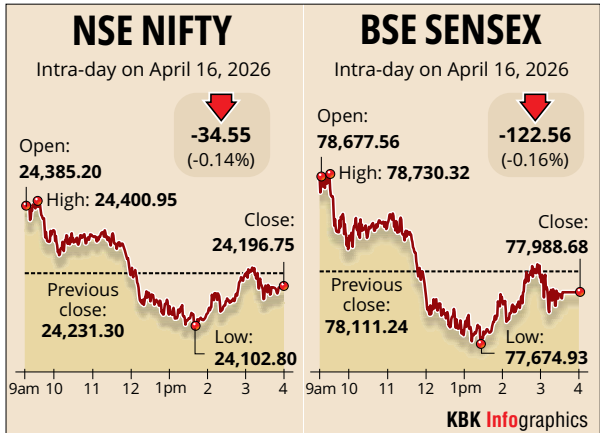
MUMBAI: Stock markets closed lower in a volatile session on Thursday with the benchmark Sensex declining by 122 points and Nifty closing below 24,200, dragged by profit-taking in banking and financial shares after a recent sharp rally.

Erasing its early gains, the 30-share BSE Sensex declined 122.56 points or 0.16 per cent to settle at 77,988.68. The index opened higher and hit a high of 78,730.32 in late-morning trading. However, profit-taking emerged at higher levels, dragging the index down to a low of 77,674.93. The index gyrated 1,055.39 points during the session.

The 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 34.55 points or 0.14 per cent to end at 24,196.75. The index moved between a high of 24,400.95 and a low of 24,102.80 during the session.

The two key indices had surged by more than 1 per cent on Wednesday following easing geopolitical tensions.

Among the 30-Sensex firms, HDFC Bank fell by more than 1.75 per cent. Titan, Mahindra & Mahindra, Bharti Airtel, Kotak Mahindra Bank and Bajaj Finance were the major



laggards.

Trent, Eternal, Adani Ports, Bharat Electronics and Infosys were among the major winners.

Broader markets closed higher with the BSE MidCap Select index climbing 0.86 per cent and the SmallCap Select index gaining 0.60 per cent. Sectorally, the trend remained mixed, with metals, IT, and energy stocks supporting the index, while banking and auto stocks faced some pressure.

"The domestic market opened positively but closed with a marginal loss on the weekly expiry day after a volatile session, as investors booked profits following recent gains.

Markets remain watchful for clarity on the second round of US-Iran negotiations, which will guide the near-term trend," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Limited, said.

The session was largely influenced by evolving geopolitical developments, with optimism around potential progress in US-Iran peace talks, which helped stabilise crude oil prices, Ajit Mishra, SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

In Asian markets, South Korea's benchmark Kospi, Japan's Nikkei 225 index, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang

Highlights

» Among the 30-Sensex firms, HDFC Bank fell the most by 1.75%. Titan, M&M, Bharti Airtel, Kotak Mahindra Bank and Bajaj Finance were the major laggards

» Broader markets closed higher with BSE MidCap Select index climbing 0.86%, SmallCap Select index gaining 0.60%

Rupee rises 19 paise to 93.14 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee strengthened by 19 paise to settle at 93.14 against the US dollar on Thursday, following a decline in global crude oil prices amid hopes of a truce in West Asia.

However, sustained outflow of foreign capital amid increased dollar demand from importers capped the gain in the local currency, forex traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 93.29 and touched an intraday high of 93.10 against the greenback.

It also fell to the day's low of 93.35 before ending the session at 93.14 against the dollar, registering a rise of 19 paise from the previous closing level. Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, surged by 0.18 per cent at 98.03.

INDIA, CHINA TO CONTRIBUTE 70% OF GROWTH

Asia will remain main driver of global growth, says IMF

WASHINGTON: Asia will remain the main driver of global growth with India and China contributing 70 per cent of the regional expansion, the IMF said Thursday, adding that the energy shock due to the Gulf crisis will negatively impact the region.

However, the five per cent regional growth witnessed in 2025, despite the impact of US tariffs and trade uncertainty, is projected to moderate to 4.4 per cent in 2026 and 4.2 per cent in 2027, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) said in its report on the Asia-Pacific segment.

"Asia entered 2026 on a solid footing with growth remaining resilient despite the region bearing the brunt of US tariffs and heightened uncertainty," Krishna Srinivasan, Director for the International Monetary Fund Asia Pacific Department told reporters here.

However, he said, given the region's high fossil fuel intensity and reliance on conflict areas for key commodities, the new energy shock will negatively impact the region.

"The shock is raising inflation, weakening external balances, tightening financial conditions, and narrowing policy space," he said.

According to the IMF, Asia consumes about 38 per cent of the world's oil and 24 per cent of its natural gas.

It's also one of the larg-



However, the 5 per cent regional growth witnessed in 2025, despite the impact of US tariffs & trade uncertainty, is likely to moderate to 4.4 per cent in 2026 and 4.2 per cent in 2027

est crude refiners, accounting for about 35 per cent of global refining capacity, which is heavily concentrated in China, India, Korea, and Singapore.

Srinivasan said growth across most Asian economies turned out stronger than expected in late 2025.

This is thanks to exports and consumption which held up better than anticipated, supported by accommodative policies and financial conditions.

"Asia's exports to the US declined but that to the rest of

the world increased," he said.

As for other growth drivers, Srinivasan said consumption recovered at different speeds across countries, while investment, not surprisingly, remained soft in many economies amid uncertainty and country-specific shocks.

"In the context of the war in the Middle East, oil and gas prices have risen sharply, and there is considerable uncertainty about how persistent this shock will be," he said.

Srinivasan said so far, inflation expectations remain broadly anchored in 2027, which gives central banks some room to look through the first-round rise in headline inflation.

"But monetary policy should remain agile. A prolonged energy shock could weaken currencies and generate more persistent inflation through exchange-rate pass-through and broader second-round effects," he said.

The Asian region's oil and gas use amounts to about four per cent of gross domestic product, nearly double Europe's share.

It exceeds 10 per cent in economies such as Malaysia and Thailand, where transport and industry play larger roles.

The conflict in the Middle East began after the US and Israel launched attacks on Iran on February 28, paralysing global energy markets and disrupting trade.

AGENCIES

Silver soars to ₹2.58L/kg, gold slips to ₹1,57,800 per 10 grams



NEW DELHI: Silver price climbed Rs 1,700 to Rs 2.58 lakh per kilogram in the national capital on Thursday due to steady demand and firm global trends, even as investors tracked geopolitical developments and currency movements.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the white metal jumped Rs 1,700, or nearly 1 per cent, to Rs 2,58,700 per kg (inclusive of all taxes) against the previous close of Rs 2,57,000 per kg.

However, gold of 99.9 per cent slipped Rs 200 to Rs 1,57,800 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes). On Wednesday, the yellow metal had finished at Rs 1,58,000 per 10 grams.

In the international markets, spot silver rose nearly 1 per cent to \$79.61 per ounce, and gold advanced by \$18.36, or 0.38 per cent, to \$4,809.16 per ounce.

Spot gold hovered around \$4,811 per ounce amid expectations that Israel and Lebanon could also agree to a ceasefire, Praveen Singh, Head of Commodities, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

‘India grow at 6.3% even if crude price averages \$130/barrel in FY27’

NEW DELHI: S&P Global Ratings on Thursday said India is expected to grow at 6.3 per cent even if the oil price averages \$130/barrel in the current fiscal year amid the West Asia crisis.

It also said that the fiscal strain from the energy price shock is unlikely to impact India's sovereign credit rating, as India has the "political commitment to fiscal consolidation" over the long term.

S&P Director, Sovereign and International Public Finance Ratings, Yee Farn Phua said considering a baseline assumption of crude at \$85/barrel, India will grow 7.1 per cent in 2026-27. "That's still a very strong number compared to any major economies out there. Even in the alternate scenario, if I were to say, \$130/barrel average, we are still looking at the growth



‘Considering a baseline assumption of crude at \$85/barrel, India will grow 7.1 per cent in 2026-27’

at 6.3 per cent... that is still going to be the highest among major economies," Phua said at a webinar.

S&P said energy supply disruptions that lead to fuel rationing or shortages of related products, such as fertilisers, would be a risk. India, S&P said, could see a weaker current account balance, higher costs for producers squeezing margins, higher consumer prices reducing purchasing power, and fiscal strains, as the government steps in to cushion some of the shock for consumers.

"The government's fiscal consolidation efforts continue to be very strong... India has a lot of physical flexibility on the spending side, especially on infrastructure. So, in case some of the areas where they have to spend more, for example, the subsidy bill, they might cut in other places to make sure that they will still hit the fiscal deficit target," Phua added.

Sebi extends duration of registration validity for not-for-profit entities on Social Stock Exchange

NEW DELHI: Markets regulator Sebi has extended the registration validity for not-for-profit organisations on the Social Stock Exchange, allowing their enrolment as NPOs for three years without raising funds, and lowered the minimum subscription requirement for issuing Zero Coupon Zero Principal Instruments (ZCZP).

The moves are aimed at promoting the SSE (Social Stock Exchange) and facilitating ease of fundraising and encouraging greater participation by NPOs, Sebi said in its circular on Wednesday. Sebi has extended the validity period to three years from the existing two years, during which NPOs can remain registered on the SSE without raising funds.

Sebi has taken into account practical challenges faced by NPOs, including delays in statu-



tory and regulatory approvals.

"It is being specified that a NPO may register on a SSE and not raise funds through it for a period of two years from the date of registration. Such period of two years may be further extended by one additional years subject to approval by the SSE," Sebi said. Additionally, the regulator has lowered the minimum subscription requirement for Zero Coupon Zero Principal instruments to 50 per cent from 75 per cent to enhance fundraising flexibility for NPOs.

This relaxation would apply

only to projects where costs and outcomes can be implemented on a clearly identifiable per-unit basis, ensuring that partial subscription does not adversely affect project execution, Sebi said. In such cases, SSEs would be required to carry out due diligence to ensure that funds raised at the lower subscription threshold can still be meaningfully deployed towards the stated objectives. Also, the regulator said that funds would be refunded to investors if the minimum subscription requirement is not met.

"The minimum subscription required to be achieved shall be 75 per cent of the funds proposed to be raised through issuance of ZCZP. Provided that the minimum subscription required to be achieved shall be 50 per cent in case where the funds raised can be deployed,

so as to be aligned with the disclosed object of the issue in a manner that the implementation of the project remains viable and meaningful," Sebi said.

"For this, the SSE shall, prior to granting in-principle approval for such partial fundraising, undertake due diligence to satisfy themselves that the funds raised towards the object(s) are capable of being deployed in a meaningful manner, taking into consideration the subscription scenarios disclosed in the fundraising document," it added. In March, the Sebi board approved a proposal to sharply reduce the minimum investment required from individual investors in social impact funds to Rs 1,000 from the existing Rs 2 lakh, in a bid to widen retail participation and ease fundraising for NPOs on the SSE.

PTI

Experts seek mandatory Nicotine awareness in school curriculum, stricter enforcement

NEW DELHI: A seminar organised by Mothers Against Vaping (MAV) brought together policymakers, educators and healthcare experts, who called for integrating values education into outcome-based learning to build a responsible and future-ready generation.

Speakers stressed that India's progress towards becoming a developed nation by 2047 depends on nurturing strong character among its youth. The event, themed "Educating for Values, Protecting Our Children," highlighted that preventing addiction is not just a regulatory issue but a broader societal responsibility.

Experts warned that vap-



ing products are deliberately designed to attract children through gadget-like designs, bright colours and appealing flavours, while aggressive social media promotion normalises their use.

Misleading terms such as

"safer alternatives" further weaken risk perception. Despite the Prohibition of Electronic Cigarettes Act (PECA), 2019, these products continue to reach students through informal channels, with supply identified as the key challenge. Stronger

enforcement was widely urged.

Ram Singh, Joint Director, Ministry of Education, emphasised coordination between education, health and enforcement agencies, announcing a three-year "Nasha Mukh Vidyalyaya" plan under Nasha Mukh Bharat.

Experts said curriculum reform alone is insufficient. Values must be demonstrated by educators, while schools should prioritise student well-being and early intervention. The seminar concluded with a call for a "National Action Plan for Guardians of Values," focusing on awareness, training, stricter enforcement and multi-stakeholder collaboration.

MPOST

Ladakh admin and Lulu Int'l ink MoU for export of Ladakhi apricots

LEH: Ladakh's famed apricots, known for their rich sweetness and distinct flavour, are poised to enter global markets in a major way this season. In a first for the Union Territory, the administration has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Lulu International to export 1,000 metric tonnes (MT) of apricots—marking a sharp rise from just 1,500 kg exported over the past two years.

The initiative follows a push by Lt. Governor VK Saxena to promote the branding and export of Ladakh's GI-tagged "Raktsey Karpo" and the region-specific "Halman" varieties. The MoU was formalised

through the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) and the Union Ministry of Food Processing Industries. It was signed by Secretary (Horticulture) Bhupesh Chaudhary and Lulu Group's Global Operations Director Salim MA in the presence of Saxena.

Under the agreement, Lulu International will procure at least 1,000 MT of apricots directly from farmers, handling harvesting, sorting, processing, packaging, transportation and global marketing while preserving Ladakh's product identity.

Currently, farmers rely on

traditional post-harvest practices, often leading to significant losses. The new arrangement is expected to reduce wastage and ensure better price realization.

Calling the MoU "historic," Saxena said it would unlock Ladakh's untapped horticulture potential, strengthen its global recognition and deliver direct economic benefits to farmers. He also indicated ongoing efforts to promote Ladakhi apples internationally.

The Lt. Governor emphasized the need for local processing infrastructure and announced plans for a dedicated e-commerce platform to provide farmers direct market access.

MPOST

Lakhwar project to boost north India's water and power security

DEHRADUN: The 300 MW Lakhwar multipurpose project on the Yamuna river is gaining momentum after a review by Jal Shakti Secretary V L Kantarao, who stressed its strategic importance for water and energy security in North India.

Kantarao directed officials to adhere to timelines and expedite work, reviewing progress on dam construction and key infrastructure. The project will regulate water supply to Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan and Delhi, while generating power for Uttarakhand.

Developed by UJVN Lim-



ited, it is expected to produce around 572 million units of renewable energy annually and support irrigation, drinking water and flood control.

UJVN Managing Director Ajay Kumar Singh said, "The

project is being closely monitored at the central level," highlighting its role in sustainable water management and green energy transition. Authorities were also asked to ensure environmental compliance.

MPOST

RBI to conduct ₹2 lakh crore 7-day variable rate reverse repo on Apr 17

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Thursday said it will conduct a Rs 2 lakh crore seven-day variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) auction on April 17, according to a release.

"In view of the surplus transient liquidity conditions prevailing, it has been decided to conduct a Variable Rate Reverse Repo (VRRR) auction on Friday, April 17, 2026," the RBI said.

The auction will take place between 9:30 am and 10:00 am, and the reversal of these funds will take place on April 24, as per the RBI's notification.

Usually, there is an outflow of funds on the 20th of



every month on account of GST payments, which puts pressure on the systemic liquidity and money market rates. The reversal of seven-day VRRR funds after the GST outflows will help the system liquidity and keep overnight rates under check.

Currently, the liquidity in the banking system is estimated

to be in surplus of around Rs 5.22 lakh crore as of April 15.

Before this, the central bank had conducted a seven-day VRRR auction on April 10 and pulled out Rs 2,00,041 crore of transient liquidity from the banking system.

These funds are set to mature on April 17.

"Going ahead, we will continue to be proactive and pre-emptive in liquidity management and ensure sufficient liquidity in the banking system to meet the productive requirements of the economy," RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said during the April monetary policy.

GREEN AWARD FOR POWERGRID



Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID) has been honored with the prestigious Green World Award 2026 in the 'Climate Change' category. The award was presented at a formal ceremony held at Cardiff Castle, Wales, U.K., recognizing POWERGRID's sustained commitment to environmental stewardship and adoption of climate-responsive operational practices. The award was received by Vipul Singh, Sr. DGM (CSR), and Manu Sinha, DGM (CSR).

MPOST

Wipro reports 1.89% decline in March qtr profit to ₹3,502 crore

For the full fiscal year of 2025-26, Wipro recorded a net profit of Rs 13,197.4 crore, reflecting 0.47% increase from Rs 13,135.4 crore in FY25

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: IT major Wipro on Thursday reported a consolidated net profit of Rs 3,501.8 crore for March quarter FY26, down 1.89 per cent from Rs 3,569.6 crore a year ago.

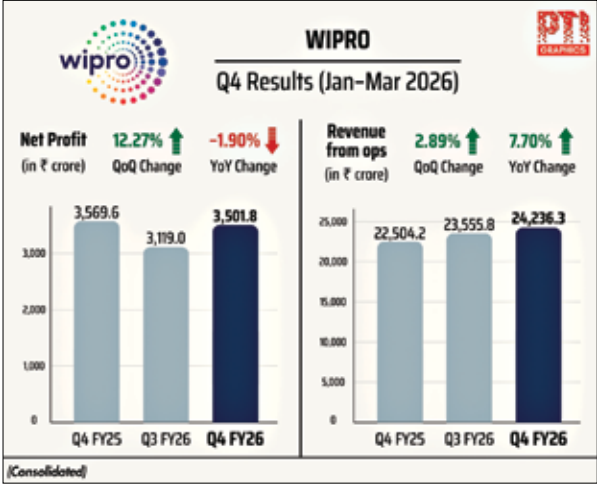
The dip in profit comes against the backdrop of a challenging macroeconomic environment, which Wipro CEO and MD Srinu Pallia described during the earnings call as the “new normal” marked by geopolitical and policy disruptions, though he noted that overall IT spending has shown resilience.

Wipro’s board has also approved a mega Rs 15,000 crore share repurchase programme, proposing to buy back more than 5 per cent of its equity, or up to 60 crore shares, from shareholders at Rs 250 per share.

The share buyback price reflects a premium of around 18 per cent over Thursday’s closing price of Rs 210.20 per share on BSE.

The Bengaluru-headquartered firm’s revenue rose 7.6 per cent to Rs 24,236.3 crore in Q4 FY26, as compared to Rs 22,504.2 crore in Q4 FY25.

Quarter-on-quarter, Wipro’s profit and revenue rose by 12.2 per cent and 2.8 per cent, respectively.



The company’s flagship IT Services segment recorded a revenue of \$2,651 million in Q4 FY26, marking a sequential uptick of 0.6 per cent and a year-on-year rise of 2.1 per cent.

For the quarter ending June 30, 2026, Wipro expects revenue from its IT Services business to be in the range of \$2,597-2,651 million. This translates to a sequential guidance of (-) 2.0 per cent to 0 per cent in constant currency

terms.

Addressing the muted guidance for the upcoming quarter, Pallia attributed the softness to a specific client issue in the Americas and delayed ramp-ups on a deal. He also noted that Q1 has traditionally been a weaker quarter for Wipro due to seasonality.

For the full fiscal year of 2025-26, Wipro recorded a net profit of Rs 13,197.4 crore, reflecting a marginal 0.47 per cent increase from Rs 13,135.4 crore in FY25. FY26 revenue stood 3.96 per cent higher at Rs 92,624 crore.

- ### Highlights
- » Wipro’s board has also approved a mega Rs 15,000 crore share repurchase programme, proposing to buy back up to 60 crore shares at Rs 250 per share
 - » The firm’s flagship IT Services segment recorded a revenue of \$2,651 mn in Q4 FY26
 - » FY26 revenue stood 3.96 per cent higher at Rs 92,624 crore

“Geopolitical and policy disruptions have become the new normal... Trade rules are changing, tighter immigration policies and of course, conflicts continue to create uncertainties for industries and economies. Despite these headwinds, IT spending has shown resilience. Cloud, data and AI continue to attract investments as they provide the infrastructure for future growth.

Our client priorities are shifting with spending decisions increasingly tied to outcomes. In fact, many of our client contracts are becoming

modular, milestone-driven and governed by value checkpoints,” Pallia said.

Total bookings for the fourth quarter stood at \$3,455 million, up 3.2 per cent quarter-on-quarter in constant currency. Large deal bookings saw a 65.1 per cent sequential surge to \$1,440 million.

Despite the headwinds, Pallia noted that the deal pipeline momentum remains strong, driven by vendor consolidation, cost management, and AI.

During the quarter under review, Wipro announced two key acquisitions—a definitive agreement to acquire Mindsprint (Olam Group’s IT services arm) for \$375 million, and another pact to acquire select customer contracts of Alpha Net Consulting for \$70.8 million.

The company’s total headcount stood at 2,42,156 at the end of FY26, as compared to 2,33,346 employees in FY25.

Chief Human Resources Officer Saurabh Govil shared that Wipro hired 7,500 freshers in FY26, with over 3,000 onboarded in Q4 alone. However, he refrained from setting a target for the next fiscal year due to the volatile demand environment.

EU planning to include 180 more products under CBAM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The EU is planning to include 180 more products under the scope of its Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) from January 2028, a move that could increase carbon tax costs on Indian-manufactured exports to Europe.

The European Parliament’s Committee on the Environment, Climate and Food Safety has recommended the expansion of the scope of CBAM.

The European Commission has come forward with this proposal, following the transitional phase of the CBAM (2023–2025), taking into account the lessons learned during this period.

The commission has proposed to expand the scope of the CBAM as of 1 January 2028 to include selected steel- and aluminium-intensive downstream products in order to address the risk that emissions are shifted along the value chain rather than effectively reduced.

“Acknowledging the risk of carbon leakage in downstream sectors, the Commission proposed a list of 180 products to be added to the current CBAM scope,” a draft report said.

Commenting on the proposal, think tank GTRI said on Thursday that Indian exporters selling into Europe may need to accelerate emissions accounting, supply-chain traceability, and decarbonisation invest-



ments to remain competitive in one of the country’s key export markets.

In a draft report issued on April 10, 2026, the European Parliament’s Committee on the Environment, Climate and Food Safety (ENVI) proposed five major changes to the CBAM regime.

The changes include extending CBAM to around 180 additional steel- and aluminium-based manufactured products from January 1, 2028; and tightening carbon accounting rules for scrap-based production by including emissions from pre-consumer scrap, the Global Trade Research Initiative (GTRI) said.

It also includes examining the expansion of the mechanism to indirect emissions from electricity use across more sectors.

“Together, these steps would turn CBAM from a tax mainly on steel and aluminium raw materials into a much wider carbon tax covering manufactured industrial goods,” GTRI founder Ajay Srivastava said.

CBAM is the EU’s border carbon tax that charges import-

ers for emissions embedded in goods produced outside Europe.

It effectively places a carbon price on foreign manufacturers selling into the EU. The mechanism acts as a climate-linked trade barrier on carbon-intensive imports.

He said that the proposed expansion would bring many new products under CBAM, including fabricated metal products, tubes, pipes, fasteners, structural components, machinery parts, aluminium containers, and other semi-finished and finished engineering goods.

The EU has not yet published product details, but the proposal shows that the levy is moving deeper into the manufacturing value chain, he added.

“The European Union is planning a major expansion of its CBAM. This move could sharply increase carbon tax costs on Indian manufactured exports to Europe,” Srivastava said.

At present, CBAM applies to imports of iron and steel, aluminium, cement, fertilisers, hydrogen, electricity, and selected steel/aluminium products.

From January 2028, Indian exporters of engineering goods, auto components, fabricated metal products, machinery, aluminium manufactures, and other industrial goods may increasingly face a carbon tax when exporting to Europe, he cautioned.

Govt to launch 15th commercial coal mine auction round today

NEW DELHI: The coal ministry will launch the 15th round of commercial coal mine auction and organise a stakeholder consultation on Friday, as part of efforts to boost private sector participation in coal production amid rising energy demands.

The consultation, to be held in Mumbai, will bring together industry players, investors and state government representatives to discuss auction modalities, mining reforms and opportunities in the commercial coal block framework.

This tranche marks a significant development in the government’s coal sector liberalisation drive, initiated in 2020, with 14 previous rounds offering over 100 blocks and attracting significant investments.



“The ministry of coal is set to organise a stakeholder consultation on Atmanirbhar Bharat: Coal for Energy Security, along with the launch of the 15th Round of Commercial Coal Mine Auctions, on 17 April 2026,” an official statement said.

Building on the success of commercial coal mine auctions, the coal ministry is advancing India’s energy sector through greater production,

efficiency and self-reliance.

The upcoming round of auction continues this progressive journey, offering coal mines under the most liberal terms to promote ease of doing business, attract diverse investments, and encourage wider industry participation, it said.

The latest auction will offer a fresh set of fully explored and partially explored coal blocks, inviting participation from experienced miners, new entrants, and technology-driven enterprises alike, the ministry statement said, adding that the move is expected to further energise the coal sector by fostering a vibrant and competitive ecosystem, while paving the way for enhanced investments, employment generation, and overall growth of the sectoral.

CCI junks complaint against Adani Group, Azure Power, others in solar tender case

NEW DELHI: Fair trade regulator CCI on Thursday rejected a complaint alleging anti-competitive practices by Adani Group entities, Azure Power, and others in a solar power tender floated by the Solar Energy Corporation of India (SECI).

The complainant had alleged that Adani Enterprises Ltd, Adani Green Energy Four Ltd, Gautam Adani, Sagar Adani, Azure Power India Pvt Ltd, SECI and several state power utilities violated competition norms.

Rejecting the complaint, the Competition Commission of India (CCI), in its order, observed that the country’s power generation market comprises many significant public and private players, and that Adani Group, prima facie, does not appear to be a dominant

player.

“As such and in view of the fact that power generation market in India is comprised of many significant players viz. National Thermal Power Corporation, Power Grid Corporation of India Ltd., Tata Power Co. Ltd., Torrent Power and Reliance Power etc., the Adani Group, prima facie, does not seem to be a dominant player in the power generation market in India,” the CCI said in the order.

The competition watchdog further said that allegations regarding cross-subsidisation, exclusionary practices and entry barriers were not supported by cogent evidence.

The complainant alleged that certain clauses, including the “Green Shoe Option,” tariff revisions, and other condi-

tions in solar tenders, restricted competition and effectively excluded smaller players.

The CCI observed that the complainant failed to establish that Adani Group held a dominant position in the relevant market.

Further, the alleged conduct i.e. offering of bribes to government officials to enable SECI to enter into Power Sales Agreements with buying utilities, in turn allowing Adani Green Energy Four to enter into Power Purchase Agreements with SECI, also does not seem to qualify as an abusive conduct (exclusionary or exploitative), within the meaning of Section 4 of the Act, the watchdog said.

With regard to the clause-specific allegations, the regulator observed that the “complainant has not pro-

vided any cogent evidence of the request for selection (RfS) documents being designed in a manner that encourages participation of only big players in the market.”

It is noted that tender design is made according to the specific requirements of the procurer, the order said.

Accordingly, the Commission is of the view that there is no prima facie case of contravention of provisions of Sections 3 and 4 of the Act warranting an investigation into the matter.

Section 3 and 4 pertain to anti-competitive agreements and abuse of dominant position, respectively.

“Therefore, the matter is directed to be closed forthwith under Section 26(2) of the Act,” the regulator said.

HDFC AMC profit dips 2.4% to ₹623 cr in March qtr

NEW DELHI: HDFC Asset Management Company (AMC) on Thursday reported 2.4 per cent decline in consolidated profit after tax (PAT) at Rs 622.66 crore for the three months ended March 2026. The company posted a PAT of Rs 638.46 crore in the year-ago period, the fund house said in a regulatory filing.

However, revenue from operations grew 17 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1,051.51 crore in the quarter under review.

The company’s board has recommended a final dividend of Rs 54 per equity share for financial year ended March 31, 2026. This is subject to shareholders’ approval.

For full FY26, the fund house’s profit after tax grew 16 per cent year-on-year to Rs 2,858.06 crore, and revenue from operations rose 18 per cent to Rs 4,122.16 crore.

Also, the board approved the appointment of Rajan Anandan as an invitee and external expert on the Technology Committee to provide an independent, high-level guidance and advise in the technology-related matters. His appointment is for a period of three years, effective April 16, 2026.

Anandan is currently a Managing Director at Peak XV Partners, a venture capital and growth investment firm. Prior to joining Peak XV, he had served as Head of Google India and South-east Asia.

India, New Zealand FTA to be signed on April 27

NEW DELHI: India and New Zealand will sign an FTA on April 27 here, an official said on Thursday.

The free trade pact aims to provide tariff-free access to the island nation’s market for domestic exporters’ goods and will bring in \$20 billion in investment over the next 15 years.

The two countries on December 22 last year announced the conclusion of negotiations for the trade deal which aims at doubling bilateral trade to \$5 billion in the next five years.

The official said that the pact will be signed on April 27 in Bharat Mandapam after a meeting of the India-New Zealand Business Forum.

While India will get zero-duty market access on 100 per cent of its exports, the agreement will eliminate or reduce tariffs on 95 per cent of New Zealand’s exports to India, including items ranging from wool, coal, wood, wine, to avocados and blueberries.

However, New Delhi has made no duty concessions on imports of dairy products like milk, cream, whey, yoghurt, and cheese; onions, sugar, spices, edible oils, and rubber to protect farmers and the domestic industry.

India, Russia hold round table to boost cooperation in steel sector

NEW DELHI: India and Russia on Thursday held a round table to strengthen cooperation in the steel sector amid global supply chain challenges, an official release said.

A Russian delegation, comprising representatives from industry and related sectors, joined Indian counterparts for discussions.

The meeting enabled constructive engagement and exchange of views on key steel sector issues like raw material sourcing, technological collaboration, equipment manufacturing, and research opportunities, the Steel Ministry said in the release.

“The India-Russia Round Table was held today at the Ministry of Steel. The meeting was co-chaired by the Secretary, Ministry of Steel... and Mikhail IURIN, Deputy Minister of Industry and Trade of the Russian Federation,” the ministry said.

During the meeting, both sides discussed various aspects of bilateral cooperation and reviewed the existing engagement between the two countries.

Discussions were held on broad areas concerning the steel sector and related industries, with a view to further strengthening cooperation.

The interaction also

enabled both sides to gain a better understanding of each other’s perspectives and explore possibilities for continued engagement in the sector.

The importance of sustained dialogue and cooperation was emphasised during the meeting.

“The discussions were held in a cordial and constructive atmosphere, reflecting the longstanding partnership between India and the Russian Federation. Both sides expressed their intent to continue engagement and further strengthen cooperation in the steel sector,” the ministry said.

HDFC Life reports 4% jump in March quarter PAT to ₹496 crore

NEW DELHI: HDFC Life Insurance on Thursday reported 4 per cent increase in stand-alone profit after tax (PAT) at Rs 495.65 crore for the three months ended March 2026 aided by higher premium income. The life insurer had clocked a PAT of Rs 476.54 crore in the January-March period of 2024-25.

Its net premium income stood at Rs 25,829 crore during the fourth quarter of FY26, up from Rs 23,765.56 crore in the same period last fiscal, HDFC Life said in a stock exchange filing.

Meanwhile, the company recommended a final dividend of Rs 2.10 per equity share of



face value of Rs 10 each for financial year 2025-26, subject to shareholders’ approval at its annual general meeting.

The company said that record date for ascertaining the entitlement of the shareholders for the final dividend will be June 19.

The Board of HDFC Life approved the issuance of 1.45 crore equity shares with a face

value of Rs 10 each, at a price of Rs 688.52 per unit, aggregating to Rs 1,000 crore, on a preferential basis to its promoter HDFC Bank.

In the full 2025-26 fiscal year, HDFC Life’s profit after tax grew 6 per cent to Rs 1,910 crore and total premium rose 12 per cent year-on-year to Rs 79,387 crore.

“During FY26, we continued to maintain our position among the top three private insurers by individual WRP. Our private sector market share stood at 15.2 per cent for 11M(April-February) FY26 “ Vibha Padalkar, Managing Director and CEO of HDFC Life, said.

Govt forms high-level inter-ministerial body to steer AI governance strategy

AIGEG will coordinate policy across ministries, departments and sectoral regulators and oversee cross-sectoral governance issues

NEW DELHI: A high-level inter-ministerial body, AI Governance and Economic Group (AIGEG), headed by Union IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw, has been constituted to steer the country’s national AI governance strategy, an official statement said on Thursday.

AI Governance and Economic Group (AIGEG) will coordinate policy across ministries, departments and sectoral regulators and oversee cross-sectoral governance issues.

“The AIGEG will operate as the apex inter-ministerial body within India’s AI governance institutional framework. It will



be supported by a Technology and Policy Expert Committee (TPEC), which will offer expert advisory to the AIGEG on global developments, emerging technologies, risks, regulation and other evolving priorities relating to AI policy and gov-

- ### CLOSER LOOK
- » The AIGEG will operate as the apex inter-ministerial body within India’s AI governance institutional framework
 - » It will be supported by a Technology and Policy Expert Committee, which will offer expert advisory to AIGEG
 - » Minister of State for Electronics and IT Jitin Prasada will serve as vice chairperson of AIGEG

ernance,” the statement said.

The inter-ministerial body will be chaired by the union electronics and IT minister Ashwini Vaishnaw whose portfolio spans railways and Information and Broadcasting.

Minister of State for Elec-

tronics and IT Jitin Prasada will serve as vice chairperson of AIGEG. The membership brings together senior stakeholders from the government across policy development, science and technology, security and economic affairs. Besides

several tasks for AI governance, AIGEG will assess the labour market impacts of AI adoption in advance, and develop mitigation strategies and transition plans that account for informality, skill diversity and regional variations.

AIGEG will work with industry and other stakeholders to develop a roadmap for AI deployment over the next decade, including assessment of job profiles affected, geographical concentration of impacts, and the extent of automation and augmentation.

It will classify AI use cases into categories such as “deploy”,

“pilot” and “defer” based on readiness in terms of data availability, skills, legal frameworks and capacity for labour adjustment.

AIGEG will review existing mechanisms and issue guidelines to ensure that firms are held accountable for compliance with local laws, oversee national initiatives on AI governance across the public and private sector, promote responsible AI innovation and beneficial deployment of AI in key sectors, study the emerging risks of AI, regulatory gaps and the need for legal amendments.

The terms of reference of

AIGEG also include development and overseeing India’s position and strategy on AI governance. “The constitution of the AIGEG gives formal effect to institutional recommendations made in India’s AI Governance Guidelines and the Economic Survey,” the statement said.

India’s AI Governance Guidelines recommend the establishment of an inter-ministerial body to steer a whole-of-government approach to AI governance, with a view to aligning the actions of ministries, departments, regulators and advisory bodies around a coherent national strategy.

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, Hari Chand Saini, S/o Sh Bahadur Singh, R/o H. No. 194/3, Gadi Mohalla, Division 18, Old Faridabad, Haryana, has severed all relations with his wife Vimla, son Pawan, his wife Monika, and son Himanshu, and has evicted them from all his movable and immovable properties. In the future, those who deal with them or have relations with them will be responsible themselves. I will not be responsible for anything.
Hari Chand Saini

Public Notice
General public notice is hereby informed that my client Mr. Tara Chand Chola S/o Shri Chetram Chola R/o House No. B-94-A, DDA Flats, Shivaji Enclave, Raguvir Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi-110027, has disowned and debarred his son Mr. Vinay Kumar, Age 44 years from all immovable and moveable assets and has severed all his relations with him as he is disobedience and working against and beyond the control of my client. **Ashok Mahamma, Advocate, Off-No. B-5, Central Market, Madangiri Dr. Ambedkar Nagar, New Delhi-110062.**

NORTHERN RAILWAY e-Tender Notice	
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:	
Name of work with its location	Outsourcing of maintenance & breakdown activities for OHE maintenance work under the jurisdiction of GHNA, BPM & JHJ TRD Depots of Delhi Division for a period of 12 months
Approx. Cost of work	Rs.3,19,95,574.75/-
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs.6,39,900/-
E-Tender Bid Online Submission period	27.04.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 11.05.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	11.05.2026 (15.00 hrs)
Fund Allocation	07041032
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
E-Tender No.: 03-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated : 15.04.2026	1258/2026
Serving Customers With A Smile	

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANSMISSION COMPANY LIMITED
CHHATTISGARH STATE LOAD DESPATCH CENTRE: RAIPUR
CIN-U4010KCT2003SGC015820 GST – 22AADCC5773E1ZX (C.G. Govt. Undertaking)
PHONE : 0771-2574172, FAX NO. 0771-2574174 Website: www.sldecg.com, Email : office@sldecg.com
e-Notice Inviting Tender (e-NIT)
No.: 03-02/SLDC/e-bidding/TR-272/77, Raipur, Dtd.: 13-04-2026
Tender No. : TR-272
Name of the Work:
Tender for the work of Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Valve-Regulated Lead-Acid (VRLA) Battery Sets for Main SLDC, Raipur and Backup SLDC, Khedamara. Online bids are invited through CSPTCL Tendering System (SAP-SRM) from Eligible Contractor/ Agencies who fulfill the Pre-Bid Qualification Criteria is opened & will be allowed registration for this tender till following date.
Important Dates:
Last date for Submission of Tender Document: 21.04.2026, upto 12:00 PM Only.
Date of opening of Tender Document: 21.04.2026 at 12:30 PM.
The detailed Tender is also available at our official website: www.sldecg.com & www.cspc.co.in.
// Save Electricity // samvad 47529/1 CSPTCL, RAIPUR

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
The Deputy Chief Material Manager/ Construction/ Kashmiri Gate, Delhi-110006, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items for and on behalf of the President of India.
(Tender No. 40265178) Last date : 15/05/2026
Sr. No.: 1 Brief Description: Supply, Design, Manufacture, Installation, Testing, Commissioning of Heavy Duty elevator of machine room less and gear less type Microprocessor based VVVF ARD System Passenger Lift (G+3) for 08 Nos. Passengers capacity complete with all accessories, floor announcement system, intercom overloading warning system, doors car & landing shall be stainless steel scratch resistant etc. as per RDSO specification No. RDSO/2013/EM/SPEC/0016(Rev-2)/2025 or latest with AMC period 10 years after expiry of warranty period. Warranty period 30 months from the date of supply or 24 months from the date of commissioning. Inspection Agency TPI, Stage inspection: No, Qty: 02 Nos.
Sr. No.: 2 Brief Description: Supply, Design, Manufacture, Installation, Testing, Commissioning of Heavy Duty elevator of machine room less and gear less type Microprocessor based VVVF ARD System Passenger Lift (G+6) for 15 Nos. Passengers capacity complete with all accessories, floor announcement system, intercom overloading warning system, doors car & landing shall be stainless steel scratch resistant etc. as per RDSO specification No. RDSO/2013/EM/SPEC/0016(Rev-2)/2025 or latest with AMC period 10 years after expiry of warranty period. Warranty period 30 months from the date of supply or 24 months from the date of commissioning. Inspection Agency TPI, Stage inspection: No, Qty: 02 Nos.
Sr. No.: 3 Brief Description: Comprehensive annual maintenance contract for the maintenance of heavy duty elevators of 8 Nos. passenger capacity for ten years after the expiry of warranty period. Warranty period: 30 month after the date of delivery. AMC period: 10 years Rate of Discounting: 8% Start after years 2, Inspection agency: CONSG, Stage inspection: NA, Qty: 02 Nos.
Sr. No.: 4 Brief Description: Comprehensive annual maintenance contract for the maintenance of heavy duty elevators of 15 Nos. passenger capacity for ten years after the expiry of warranty period. Warranty period: 30 month after the date of delivery. AMC period 10 years Rate of Discounting: 8% Start after years 2, Inspection agency: CONSG, Stage inspection: NA, Qty: 02 Nos.
Note:- 1. Detailed information can be seen on the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in. 2. Manual tender will not be accepted.
No.-Dy. CMM/CN/R/40265178 Date: 16/04/2026 1259/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr.Pc.
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Kishlay Thakur @ Ashish Kumar s/o Mahesh Thakur** R/o 005, Eklayva Appt. Sanjay Enclave, Uttam Nagar, Delhi at also: 402, Sharavani Enclave, Sohagi, Sambal Chak, Patna, Bihar, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **case/FIR.No. 99/24 u/s 420/408/467/468 & 471/120B/34 IPC, has been registered at P.S. Dwarka North Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Kishlay Thakur @ Ashish Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Kishlay Thakur @ Ashish Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Kishlay Thakur @ Ashish Kumar of FIR.No. 99/24 u/s 420/408/467/468 & 471/120B/34 IPC, registered at PS. Dwarka North, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.05.2026**
By Order
Sh. Rahul Katara
JMFC-06, (SDJ)
Dwarka Courts, New Delhi
DP/4783/DW/2026
(court notice)

CHHATTISGARH STATE POWER TRANSMISSION COMPANY, LTD.
(A Govt. of Chhattisgarh undertaking) (A successor company of CSEB)
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (STORE & PURCHASE)
Third Floor, SLDC Building, CSPTCL, Dagauniya Raipur-492013
No.02-16/SE(S&P)-TR-25/S&P/41/0078 Raipur, Dtd. 16-04-2026
E - BIDDING TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited by the undersigned through CSPTCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from experienced manufacturers/eligible bidders for Supply of following material-

S.N.	Tender no./RFx No.	Description	Due Date & time
1.	TR-25/S&P/41 RFx No-8100050790	132 KV SF6 Circuit Breaker	12.05.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs

The details of NIT can be viewed from our website www.cspc.co.in and the Tender Documents can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal:- <https://ebidding.cspc.co.in:50724/irj/portal>. Any amendment/corrigendum, if required, will be displayed on our website only.
CHIEF ENGINEER (S&P)
SAVE ELECTRICITY s 47524/1 CSPTCL: RAIPUR

CENTRAL RAILWAY
Pune Division
CORRIGENDUM
Corrigendum No. 1 for Tender Notice No. ELS_DD_PSU Date. 24.03.2026
Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Rolling Stock), Electric Loco Shed, Central Railway, Daund, Pune for and behalf of The President of India has invited tender through IREPS portal Name of work:- **Operation and maintenance of Electric Loco Shed Daund (Pune Division, Central Railway) and Maintenance of WAG9H locomotives** was published on IREPS on date 24.3.2026 and in newspaper dated 27.3.2026
In this regard tender submission end date preponed to 21.05.2026 and pre bid conference on 20.04.2026
All other terms and conditions of the tender remains unchanged.
17 **Sr.DEE (TRS), Daund**
Traveling with dangerous and explosive goods is a punishable offense

Two good for MI

Prabhsimran and Iyer lead PBKS as they maul Mumbai Indians

MUMBAI: Prabhsimran Singh and Shreyas Iyer struck fluent fifties as Punjab Kings' winning run continued with a seven-wicket hammering of Mumbai Indians, who suffered a fourth consecutive defeat in the Indian Premier League here on Thursday.

Even as Quinton de Kock, with a brilliant 112 not out, and Naman Dhir (50) bailed Mumbai Indians out in the first half with a robust 132-run third-wicket stand, the hosts' 195/6 was never challenging enough on a docile track against the rampant Punjab batters.

Prabhsimran made a wicketless Jasprit Bumrah (0/41) and MI pay for a regulation drop early, smashing a strokeful 80 not out off 31 balls, while skipper Iyer was in his elements, notching up his third fifty in as many outings with a 66 off 35 balls, as the duo stitched a sturdy 139-run stand for the third wicket.

Chasing 196, PBKS went over the line with 21 balls to spare, scoring 198/3 as MI bowlers continued to disappoint collectively, with AM Ghazanfar's 2/31 being the only performance of note.

Punjab were quick off the blocks as the first over from Deepak Chahar yielded



PBKS' Prabhsimran Singh and captain Shreyas Iyer bump fists during the match

PTI

21 runs, putting MI on the backfoot.

A pivotal moment arrived in the third over when Bumrah, placed at short third, spilled a regulation chance off Hardik Pandya when Prabhsimran was only on 11.

Ghazanfar dismissed Priyansh Arya (15) and Cooper Connolly (17) to give Mumbai two elusive wickets in the powerplay, but the hosts could never capitalise on those breakthroughs.

Prabhsimran unleashed his

rich repertoire of strokes, hitting a flurry of fours, while Iyer relished batting on his home track of the Wankhede Stadium, dispatching the bad balls with ease.

Their 139-run stand came from only 67 balls as Prabhsimran and Iyer eclipsed the first-innings heroics of de Kock and Dhir.

In the 16th over, a powerful pull from Iyer went through Dhir's hands for a six and the Punjab skipper sent the next from Shardul Thakur flying into the stands. However, a flick off

the pads in the air gave Dhir another chance, which he converted with a fine diving catch in the front.

Earlier, a belligerent century from Quinton de Kock (112 not out) and a gritty 50 from Naman Dhir pulled MI out of doldrums and lifted them to an under-par 195/6.

Confined to warming the bench so far, de Kock replaced Rohit Sharma and smacked his third IPL hundred to lead an inspirational fightback for the troubled MI.

AGENCIES

Goals galore as Bayern enter UCL semis

MUNICH: Bayern Munich turned the tables on old rivals Real Madrid.

Luis Diaz and Michael Olise scored late for the Bavarian powerhouse to beat Madrid 4-3 and advance to the Champions League semifinals on Wednesday. In the last four two-legged ties between the sides, the Spanish giants had prevailed each time.

The second-leg quarterfinals game ended in acrimony with Madrid's players furious that referee Slavko Vincic sent off substitute Eduardo Camavinga in the 86th minute with a second yellow card for an innocuous challenge on Harry Kane.

Diaz fired inside the right post three minutes later and Olise ended the contest definitively with a spectacular strike in stoppage time to give Bayern a 6-4 win on aggregate after the Bavarian powerhouse won the first leg of their quarterfinal 2-1 in Madrid last week. Madrid's players surrounded Vincic after the game. Arda Guler was shown a red card for his complaints.

"Everything was over with the red card," Madrid coach Alvaro Arbeloa said of Camavinga's sending off. "It's unbelievable. You cannot send off a player for this action."

Bayern will play Paris Saint-Germain in the semifinals. Also Wednesday, Arsenal advanced past Sporting Lisbon to set up a last-four showdown against Atlético Madrid.

AGENCIES

KKR search for answers against GT

AHMEDABAD: An under pressure Kolkata Knight Riders would be hoping to arrest their steep slide against a resurgent Gujarat Titans in the Indian Premier League here on Friday.

Under captain Ajinkya Rahane and coach Abhishek Nayar, KKR have struggled for clarity, slumping to four defeats in five matches and still searching for their first win of the season.

It's their misfortune that their bowling had weakened significantly before the tournament following the injury setbacks to Harshit Rana and Akash Deep and the release of Mustafizur Rahman from BCCI instructions. But the bigger concern was the dip in form of their spin mainstays Sunil Narine and Varun Chakravarthy. The Indian spinner is still in the struggle phase and is yet to take a wicket this season.

AGENCIES

T20 WORLD CUP PREPS ON Harmanpreet & Co out to conquer South Africa



The Indian captain says her side is confident to make a mark

FILE

DURBAN: Emphasising the need to give all players adequate opportunities ahead of the T20 World Cup, India captain Harmanpreet Kaur on Thursday said her side is confident and keen to make the most of the five-match T20I series against South Africa starting here on Friday.

Harmanpreet also said that her side is brimming with confidence following their ODI World Cup triumph. India recently registered T20I series wins over Australia and Sri Lanka. The skipper stressed that the matches would offer a valuable opportunity to fine-tune combinations and build momentum ahead of the global event in England and Wales from June 12 to July 5.

"We want to take this opportunity very seriously and play our best cricket here. It's a great chance for us to come together and prepare well before the World Cup," Har-

The team is in good shape and this series is very important for us before the World Cup
— Harmanpreet Kaur

manpreet said at the pre-series press conference.

Harmanpreet underlined that giving opportunities to all players in the five-match series would be a priority. "These matches are important to ensure all players get equal opportunities so that we are fully ready as a unit going into the World Cup. At the same time, we are here to win," she noted. "The team is quite confident."

AGENCIES

French Open prize money up by 10%

NEW DELHI: French Open prize money has increased by about 10% for an overall pot of 61.7 million euros (\$72.1 million). The total amount is up 5.3 million euros from last year. Play begins on Sunday, May 24 at Roland Garros in west-ern Paris.

Men's and women's singles champions each receive 2.8 million euros and the runners-up 1.4 million euros. Semifinalists earn 750,000 euros and first round losers get 87,000 euros. Men's and women's doubles winners pocket 600,000 euros and the mixed doubles champions get 122,000 euros.

Last year, Carlos Alcaraz staged an epic comeback to beat Jannik Sinner in a five-set final and Coco Gauff defeated Aryna Sabalenka.

AGENCIES

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम
कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, भदभदा रोड संभाग क्रमांक-03
भोपाल-462003, Mobile No. : 9425601545
ई-मेल : mpphidcbpl3@gmail.com
क्र.मप्रपुआअविनि/424/पयं/भोपाल-03/तश/2026
भोपाल, दिनांक : 16.04.2026

प्रेस विज्ञापित

भोपाल संभाग-3 के पुलिस विभाग योजनातर्गत जिला रायसेन एवं विदिशा में थाओं एवं आवासों के मरम्मत कार्य हेतु निविदा क्रमांक-01/2026-27 (ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक-500801,500803, 500804 आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक 27.04.2026 सायं 5:00 बजे तक ऑनलाइन खरीदे एवं दस्तावेज अपलोड किये जा सकते हैं। विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण Portal : <https://www.mptenders.gov.in> पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
म.प्र. माध्यम/125368/2026 परियोजना यंत्री

NORTHERN RAILWAY TENDER NOTICE (Through e-Tendering)	
Name of work with its location	Improvement works in section under Sr. DSTE-I for enhancement of reliability and focus on PRIME items.
App. Cost of the work	Rs. 5,64,22,152.38/- Bid Security Rs. 11,28,500.00/-
Address of the office	Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3rd Floor, Annexe-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055
Date & Time for uploading the tender/closing of the tender	Tender uploading 15.04.2026 / closing date & time- 08.05.2026 up to 15.00 hrs.
Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc.	See the Northern Railway website www.ireps.gov.in & Notice board at the S&T branch, 3rd Floor, DRM Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055.
Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-TENDER-1470, Date: 15.04.2026 SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1257/2026	

ई० - प्रोक्तोरमेन्ट सेल
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
अवल निर्माण विभाग, अवल प्रमण्डल, दुमका
ई-प्रोक्तोरमेन्ट अत्यकालीन नोटिस
टेन्डर रेफरेन्स नं० - 05/2026-27/EE/BCD/DUMKA, दिनांक - 16.04.2026

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रु० में)	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण पित्र क मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	Proposed Construction of ITI Building Along with Classroom at Dumka.	Rs.3,75,30,500/-	Rs.3,75,500/-	Rs.10,000/-	11 माह

1. वेबसाइट पर निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि / समय :- 04-05-2026 के 11:00 बजे
2. बिड प्राप्ति के लिए अन्तिम तिथि / समय :- 19-05-2026 के 11:00 बजे
3. निविदा प्रकाशित करने वाले कार्यालय का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, भवन निर्माण विभाग, भवन प्रमण्डल, दुमका।
4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि / समय एवं स्थान :- 20-05-2026 के 11:30 बजे
नोडल पदाधिकारी, ई० - प्रोक्तोरमेन्ट सेल, मुख्य अभियंता का कार्यालय, भवन निर्माण विभाग, झारखंड, राँची।
5. प्रोक्तोरमेन्ट पदाधिकारी का सम्यक् संचालन :- 4120084525
6. ई - प्रोक्तोरमेन्ट सेल का हेल्पलाइन संचालन :- 6200213814
7. परिमाण विषय की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि भेज होगी।
8. सूचना प्रौद्योगिकी एवं ई-गवर्नेंस विभाग, झारखण्ड सरकार के आदेश ज्ञापक-120 दिनांक-03.10.2023 के द्वारा निर्गत SOP (मानक संचालन प्रक्रिया) एवं भवन निर्माण विभाग, झारखण्ड सरकार के पत्रांक-2229 दिनांक-06.10.2023 के आलोक में निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।
9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुग्तान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, SOP के तहत अग्रघन की राशि उसी खाते में वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बन्द कर दिया जाता है तो उसकी सम्पूर्ण जवाबदेही निविदादाता की होगी।
10. अन्य किसी भी प्रकार के बदलाव की सूचना <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, भवन निर्माण विभाग, भवन प्रमण्डल, दुमका
PR 377603 Building(26-27).D

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL) AU & PC, CSPGCL,
Shed No. 2, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2576320 & 0771-2576324, website: www.cspc.co.in E-mail:- cecivil.aupc@gmail.com
No. 03-15/W/56 Raipur, date 10.04.2026

SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited through CSPL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from eligible bidders fulfilling the eligibility criteria as mentioned below and having experience in Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Local bodies/Power Generating Companies in India only for the following work :-

Sl. No.	Tender Specification No.	Description	NIT value i/c (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Completion period (incl. Rainy season)	RfX No.
1	CEC/AU&PC/HTPS-KW/W/2025/146	Ash Utilization by disposal of ash in eco-friendly manner from Ash Dyke Dindolbhatta of 1x500 MW Extn., HTPS, CSPGCL Korba West for land development of Bilaspur Municipal Corporation land parcels at Bilaspur Sendri for Proposed CBG Plant and MRF sites (PART-I).	488.21 Lacs	4,88,300/-	03 Months	81000 50632
2	CEC/AU&PC/HTPS-KW/W/2025/147	Ash Utilization by disposal of ash in eco-friendly manner from Ash Dyke Jhabu of 4x210 MW, HTPS, CSPGCL Korba West for land development of Bilaspur Municipal Corporation land parcels at Bilaspur Sendri for Proposed CBG Plant and MRF sites (PART-II).	438.24 Lacs	4,38,300/-	03 Months	81000 50640

Cost of tender form is Rs. 1180/- (Rs.1000/- + 18% GST). The due date & time for submission of bids, Tender Cost & EMD is 06.05.2026 (up to 15:00 Hrs) and bid opening date (Techno commercial bids) is 08.05.2026 (up to 16:00) Hrs respectively. The tender document can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in:50724/irj/portal>.
Note:- (i) The L-1 bidder shall be decided on overall cost to company basis including GST.(ii) In case, the rate quoted by the bidder is on abnormally lower side, a performance guarantee @5% of contract value i/c GST in addition to Security Deposit shall have to be deposited by the bidder.(iii) Maintenance period for the work shall be 12 (Twelve) Months.(iv) Subletting of contract will not be allowed.
Chief Engineer (Civil) AU & PC, CSPGCL, Raipur
//Save Electricity// samvad 47492/1

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE
APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Manoj@Monu**, S/o: Rambhul, R/o: H.No. 11/121, Trilok Puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 539/2023, U/s: 376(2)/506 IPC, Police Station Kalyan Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Manoj@Monu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Manoj@Monu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Manoj@Monu** of **Police Station Kalyan Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Pragya Gupta
CJM, East, Room No. 29,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/4940/ED/2026



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. JHS-N-W-38-26
Date: 14.04.2026

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open tender through online (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-38-26

Description of work: Provision of Interlocking of LC Gates No. 394, 406, 409, 410 and S-46 having TVU greater than 10,000 & < 20,000 of Jhansi Division

Approx Cost : ₹ 29740464.08/-
Earnest Money: ₹ 5948000/-

Cost of Tender Form: Nil	Opening of tender: 13.05.2026 Time 15.00
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance: 18 Months	

• Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 13.05.2026 * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irps.gov.in. (**NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T**)

North central railways
@CPRONCR
www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

820/26 FA

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.P/Agra/Gaz./Medical/CMP Dated: 13.04.2026

NOTIFICATION

In reference to above subject, a notification was issued for engagement of two Contract Medical Practitioner (General Duty Medical Officer) (one EWS and one OBC) on Contract basis for one year in Agra division of North Central Railway Agra Division vide even number letter dated **05.03.2026** of this office. The Walk-In-Interview again will be held on **23.04.2026 (Thursday)** at **10.00 hrs.** in Personnel Branch, DRM Office/Agra due to the reason the vacancies were not filling on Walk-In-Interview held on **20.03.2026**. EWS vacancy can be filled by unreserved candidate, if suitable candidate of EWS category will not be found. The notification dated **05.03.2026** issued in this regard can be seen on the NC Railway website www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in > **Aboutus> Division> Agra Division> Medical.**

Sr. Divisional Personnel Officer,
North Central Railway, Agra

812/26 FA

North central railways @CPRONCR www.indianrailways.gov.in



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No: T-04-N-2026-27
Date: 13.04.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N.C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites **"Open Tender"** through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Tender No. T-04-N-2026-27

Name of work with its location & Completion Period: Agra Division:- Provision of Replacement of wiring and light poles of Non-Interlocked LC gates over Agra Division., **Completion period 08 months**

Approx. Cost of the work: Rs. 6481546.20

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. Tenders can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs on 06.05.2026. **81126 (D)**

 www.northcentralrailways.gov.in
 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in
 [05222600000](tel:05222600000)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No.: JHS-N-W-35-26
Dated : 14.04.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No. : JHS-N-W-35-26	Approx Cost : Rs. 15475685.18/-
Description of work : Reliability improvement work of signalling & telecom gears under jurisdiction of ADSTE/MB(A)(MBA-TKMG) section of Jhansi division.	
Earnest Money : Rs. 309500.00/-	Cost of Tender Form : Nil.

Opening of tender : 08.05.2026 Time : 15:00

Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months

* Tender on line can be submitted upto **15:00 hrs on 08.05.2026**. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irps.gov.in (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 818/26 (C)

 North central railways division

 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

 [CPNCRNCR](mailto:CPNCRNCR@ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.	Approx Cost	Earnest Money
JHS-ENG-G-2026-74	11673150.35	233500.00

Description of work: Inspection and Maintenance of track (new double line) between RGU-JSB section under ADEN/BNDA for 18 months.

Date of closing Tender: 07.05.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 18 Months

• Tender online can be submitted upto to 15:00 hrs on 07.05.2026. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.treps.gov.in 804/26 ADM

 North central railways
 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in
 @CPRONCR

	NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY			
No. S/Sale/611/E-AP/170758/2026-27		Date: 13.04.2026		
E-AUCTION NOTICE				
E-AUCTION PROGRAMME, NOTICE NO.02 MONTH OF MAY-2026				
It is intimated that scrap materials available in all Divisions and Depots of North Central Railway will be sold through e-auction and all organizers will conduct the auction of their area. Scrap Items: P Way Scrap, Scrap Rail, Cast Iron Scrap, Condemned rolling Stock, Non ferrous and Non metallic Scrap, Turning & Boring, Condemned Oil /Paints Drums, Condemned Machinery & plants, Condemned Vehicles, Condemned office equipments, Foundry Slag, Released overhead MS/GI tanks, Released ferrous scrap of train lighting fans, Released MS/GI pipeline, foundry skull, Workshop MS scrap and other MS scrap.				
SN	E-auction Date & Day	Depot/Division	Organizer of Auction	Through Website
1.	07.05.2026 Thursday	General Stores Depot/ Jhansi	Deputy Chief Material Manager/ System/ Jhansi	www.ircps.gov.in
2.	14.05.2026 Thursday			
3.	21.05.2026 Thursday			
4.	28.05.2026 Thursday			
5.	05.05.2026 Tuesday	General Stores Depot/Kanpur	Dy. Chief Material Manager/General Store Depot/ Kanpur	
6.	14.05.2026 Thursday			
7.	25.05.2026 Monday			
8.	05.05.2026 Tuesday			
9.	12.05.2026 Tuesday	Prayagraj Division	Senior Divisional Material Manager/North Central Railway/Prayagraj.	
10.	19.05.2026 Tuesday			
11.	26.05.2026 Tuesday			
12.	06.05.2026 Wednesday			
13.	13.05.2026 Wednesday	Jhansi Division	Senior Divisional Material Manager/North Central Railway/Jhansi.	
14.	20.05.2026 Wednesday			
15.	29.05.2026 Friday			
16.	07.05.2026 Thursday			Agra Division
17.	14.05.2026 Thursday			
18.	21.05.2026 Thursday			
19.	28.05.2026 Thursday			
Special Conditions: 1. All type of scraps will be through e-auction mode www.ircps.gov.in website. In the event of auction not being completed on the same calendar day, auction may be continued on the next calendar days also. 2. The unsold lots of e-auction will also be included in next e-auction of respective depot. 3. The Intending purchaser may inspect the lot of scrap material before the auctions during working hours. 4. To purchase material above Rs. 5 Lacs, the purchaser must be registered with GST. 5. For further details on auctions (like catalogues, last sold rates in auctions & other details), Please visit North Central Railway's website "www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in". 6. For further detail regarding e-auction, Please visit "www.ircps.gov.in" website. 807/26(Dg)				
  North central railways  @CPNROCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in 				

 NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY	
T. Notice No. 230-Elect/TRD/PRY/J-E-Tender Notice/2026/628	Date: 13.04.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE	
Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer-TENDER/ND.N.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-	
T. No.: 230-TRD-WC-1017-2026	
Description of work: 25KV OHE modification work due to Interlocking of 10 nos. mid-section non interlocked LC Gates in branch lines over Prayagraj division.	
Advised value: Rs. 3,56,84,062.18	Bid Security: Rs. 7,13,700.00
Completion Period: 12 Months	Bidding system: Single Packet
Tender Closing date & Time: 05.05.2026 & 14:00 Hrs	
Tender opening date & Time: 05.05.2026 & 15:00 Hrs	
Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. 3. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached.	
813/26 (ADM)	
 www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in 	



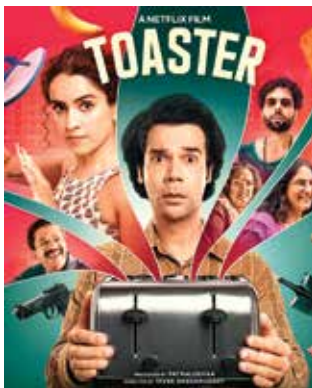
‘Grateful for the opportunities’

Sanya Malhotra completes a decade in Bollywood

Sanya Malhotra, who made her Hindi cinema debut with ‘Dangal’ in 2016, said her journey in Hindi cinema has been nothing but surreal and she hopes that her films continue to receive love from the audiences.

The actress now stars in ‘Netflix’ comedy ‘Toaster’ opposite Rajkummar Rao. The film marks the production debut of Rao and his wife Patralekhaa through ‘Kampa Film’. It revolves around a miser who wants to get back the toaster he gifted at a wedding when the ceremony is called off. Malhotra plays his wife. “10 years... It’s surreal. It’s been amazing, quite fulfilling and I am so grateful for the opportunities that I get,” Malhotra told PTI.

The actress said that though she has worked with Rao in two different projects - ‘Hit: The First Case’ and ‘Ludo’, this is the first time that they have spent a lot of time working together.



She said her journey in Hindi cinema has been nothing but surreal

“I am so happy to be a part

of ‘Toaster’. I got a call from Raj saying that we are making a film and even before I read it, I was like, ‘Of course. If he is attached to something, then it has to be really good. It can’t be just anything’. This is our third film together. I was in a suitcase in the first one (‘Hit’). We were not together in the other (‘Ludo’). So, I was dying to work with Raj because we all know how incredible he is as an actor. And this was the perfect opportunity,” she said.

Rao said Malhotra’s work in ‘Toaster’ is her finest in the space of comedy. Patralekhaa said Malhotra was a ‘riot’ on the movie’s set.

Malhotra was praised for her performance in ‘Mrs’, a remake of the critically acclaimed Malayalam movie ‘The Great Indian Kitchen’. The actress said she is grateful for the love that the movie received, but she does not take it as pressure. “I just hope that all my other films and all the other projects that I’m doing will get the same kind of love and respect.” PTI

‘Saat Paake Bandha’ to screen at Moscow Film Festival



The film fest is on till April 23

OUR CORRESPONDENT

In a proud moment for India’s cinematic legacy, the restored version of the iconic Bengali film ‘Saat Paake Bandha’ (1963) will be showcased in the ‘Out-of-Competition’ section at the 48th Moscow International Film Festival, scheduled to take place from April 23 to April 23, 2026. The 4K restoration of the film has been undertaken by Prasad Corporation, India’s leading film restoration and post-production facility.

Directed by Ajoy Kar and produced by RD Bansal, ‘Saat Paake Bandha’ stars Soumitra Chatterjee and Suchitra Sen. The film is a nuanced exploration of marriage and individuality, tracing a relationship that unravels under ego, class divides and societal pressures. Known for its emotional honesty, it remains strikingly relevant today. Sen was the first Indian actress to receive an award at an international film festival when, at the 1963 Moscow International Film Festival, she won the Silver Prize for ‘Best Actress’ for ‘Saat Pake Bandha’. And now, decades later, her film will be screened at the same international film festival.

A 35mm release print from archival collections was scanned at 4K resolution for picture restoration. The scanned film element exhibited numerous issues, including dust, dirt, extended line scratches, splice marks, stains, film tears, emulsion damage, image instability and flicker. Running scratches, emulsion damage and heavy stains posed the most complex

challenges of the entire restoration.

To address this, the restoration team employed a combination of filters and in the most severe cases, manual retouching, painstakingly reconstructing image information using surrounding undamaged frames and the restorers’ understanding of the film’s original visual intent.

The film will be screened at the same festival where Suchitra Sen won ‘Best Actress’ in 1963, marking a landmark moment for Indian cinema

The restoration forms part of the Government of India’s National Film Heritage Mission, dedicated to preserving India’s cinematic legacy. The film’s selection at the Moscow International Film Festival marks a full-circle moment, returning it to the stage where it first gained global acclaim over six decades ago. The restored version will be screened during the festival dates, with the presentation by Varsha Bansal, granddaughter of producer R D Bansal.

Over the years, Saat Paake Bandha has continued to influence storytelling in Indian cinema, inspiring adaptations across languages and generations. Its sensitive portrayal of human relationships and social structures ensures that it remains not just a film but also a cultural touchstone.

SUSHILA DEVI AWARD 2026

Bhopal Literature & Art Festival announces call for entries

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The organisers of the Bhopal Literature & Art Festival are pleased to announce the call for entries for the Sushila Devi Award 2026, instituted by the Shri Ratanlal Foundation. This prestigious award recognises the ‘Best Book of Fiction’ written by a woman author, published in the calendar year 2025.

The award will be presented during the upcoming Bhopal Literature & Art Festival, scheduled to be held from January 8 to January 10, 2027, in Bhopal.

Carrying forward its commitment to celebrating literary excellence and amplifying women’s voices in literature, the Sushila Devi Award honours outstanding original fiction written in English by women authors of Indian nationality or Indian origin.

The prize amount of the coveted award is Rs 2,25,000. As for the year of eligibility, the books must be published between January 1, 2025 and December 31, 2025. The last date for submission is August 15, 2026. The key eligibility criteria are:

❖ **Minimum length:** 40,000 words

(full-length fiction)

- ❖ Must be an original work in English
- ❖ Not self-published
- ❖ Not exclusively an e-book
- ❖ The author must be living at the time of submission

This prestigious award recognises the ‘Best Book of Fiction’ written by a woman author

While the shortlist announcement will be done before December 15, 2026, the winners will be declared by December 31, 2026.

Entries must be submitted exclusively through publishers, who may nominate up to three titles. Each submission must include four hard copies of the book. All the entries should be sent to Sulakshna Choudhry (Coordinator - Book Award), 119, Indus Empire Phase-2, E-8 Extension, Gulmohar, Bhopal - 462039. Phone number: +91-9893046385.

Lee Dong-wook to lead new Netflix series ‘The Facade of Love’

South Korean star Lee Dong-wook is set to headline Netflix’s upcoming series ‘The Facade of Love’, the streaming platform announced. The show will feature him alongside a strong ensemble cast that includes Jeon So-nee, Jung Yu-mi and Lee Jong-won, a press release said.

Directed by Mo Wan-il, known for ‘The World of the Married’ and ‘The Frog’ and written by Ha Su-jin, who previously penned ‘The Matchmakers’ and ‘Sell Your Haunted House’, the series explores what happens when a single night away from routine sets off a chain of consequences across four lives. In the show, Dong-wook will play the role of Ji-hun, a man caught between what he feels and what he believes is right.

One of South Korean television’s most recognisable faces, he rose to widespread fame with the fantasy romance ‘Guardian: The Lonely and Great God’ opposite Gong Yoo and has since starred in ‘Tale of the Nine Tailed’, the psychological thriller ‘Hell Is Other People’ and the romance drama ‘Touch Your Heart’.

The show will feature him alongside Jeon So-nee, Jung Yu-mi and Lee Jong-won

The story begins when Ji-hun and Hu-kyung, two strangers far from home, share an unforgettable night together. Though both expect to return to their ordinary lives in Korea, the connection between them follows them back, slowly unravelling the lives of four people, according to the official plotline.

So-nee, known for creature thriller ‘Parasyte: The Grey’, romance drama ‘Melo Movie’ and the supernatural series ‘As You Stood By’, plays Hu-kyung, the unexpected centre of Ji-hun’s emotional upheaval.

Yu-mi of ‘Train to Busan’ fame takes on the role of Sun-hee, Ji-hun’s wife - a woman confronted with a shocking truth. PTI



CELEBRATING THE ART OF SAREE-WEAVING FROM BANGLADESH

OUR CORRESPONDENT

The Bangladesh High Commission to India is presenting a first-ever exposition celebrating the country’s rich handloom heritage - ‘Celebrating the art of saree-weaving from Bangladesh’ - with a special focus on Sarees from two traditional weaving hubs in Bangladesh, the districts of Tangail and Pabna, that embody centuries of craftsmanship, cultural memory and artistic excellence.

Building on the success of the first-ever similar exposition on Jamdani in New Delhi (Crafts Museum, September 2025), this showcase essentially underlines a compelling cultural narrative - shifting the lens from the celebrated muslin-based Jamdani to the refined, versatile elegance of Tangail and Pabna weaving traditions.

As much as displaying textiles, this endeavour is equally to tell the tales of weavers - their lives and creative legacies - before public consciousness. The exposition will be inaugurated on April 17, 2026 (5 pm - 7 pm) in the presence of diplomats, cultural personalities, media and distinguished textile enthusiasts. It will be open to the wider public from April 18 to April 21, 2026, daily from 10 am to 8 pm.



A Legacy Woven Through Time

Tangail sarees trace their origins to centuries ago, carrying with them refined techniques that would evolve uniquely in the fertile riverine delta in Bangladesh. Over time, Tangail became synonymous with fine cotton sarees featuring delicate motifs, airy textures and an understated sophistication ideal for both

everyday elegance and ceremonial wear.

Pabna, another historic weaving hub, developed its own identity, often characterised by durability, subtle patterns and an emphasis on comfort without compromising aesthetic appeal. Together, Tangail and Pabna - across the banks of the river Jamuna - represent a harmonious blend of tradition and adaptability in Bangladesh’s textile history.

An interesting facet of Tangail sarees lies in their weaving technique, where extra weft is used to create intricate motifs directly on the loom, an approach that shares philosophical kinship with Jamdani weaving, though expressed in a more structured and accessible form. This connection highlights a broader continuum within Bengal’s textile traditions, where innovation emerges from deeply rooted practices.

Recognition and Revival

The exposition comes at a particularly significant moment. Last December (2025), the art of Tangail saree weaving received universal recognition as an Intangible Cultural Heritage by UNESCO. This affirmed its cultural importance and the resilience of the artisan communities who sustain it. This recognition has renewed global interest in Bangla-

desh’s handloom sector, which remains a vital source of livelihood for thousands of rural families.

What Visitors Can Expect

Textile traditions are mostly passed quietly through generations, serving as a powerful medium of connection, reflecting shared histories, climates and aesthetics. These define a people and their living tradition, one that continues to

evolve while remaining deeply anchored in its roots.

The exposition will feature over 300 carefully curated sarees, showcasing a wide spectrum from heritage pieces that echo age-old designs to contemporary interpretations reflecting evolving tastes.

In addition, visitors will experience a visual documentation of the saree-making process, offering insight into each stage of creation from spinning fine cotton threads and natural dyeing to the rhythmic precision of loom weaving and final finishing. This immersive presentation brings forward the human stories behind the fabric. It is patience, skill and generational knowledge embedded in every weave.

Curatorial Collaboration

The exposition is curated by Chandra Shekhar Saha (Bangladesh) and Chandra Shekhar Veda (India), both veterans of the textile and handicrafts sectors, who have graduated from NID. Their collaboration reflects a cross-border commitment to preserving and promoting South Asia’s shared textile heritage. Their previous work on the Jamdani exposition was widely appreciated for its depth and narrative richness, setting the stage for this new chapter.